

Curriculum Stories

English

الصف الثاني عشر

Term 1

One story for every lesson: enjoy the story and learn the whole lesson

24 stories

How to use this book

📚 One story per lesson

Each story teaches a whole lesson from your book, in the same order.

🖍️ Highlighted words

Highlighted words are the key words of the lesson.

💡 Facts

Small boxes inside the story give facts you should remember.

📖 Words

At the end of each story you find the key words with their meaning in Arabic.

🌟 What did I learn?

A short list of what the lesson teaches. Read it to check yourself.

🤔 Little questions

Try to answer alone, then look at the answer.

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Lesson 1-1 · A Fair Exchange (Reading: skimming)

The Frankincense Box

A family story Theme 1: Retail Therapy

👥 Salim, a Grade 12 student in Muscat, his sister Maryam, and their grandfather in Salalah

In the summer holiday, Salim and Maryam visited their grandfather in Salalah. On the first evening, Grandfather opened an old wooden box. A sweet smell filled the room.

"This is **frankincense**," he said. "Our family **traded** it for hundreds of years."

A long history

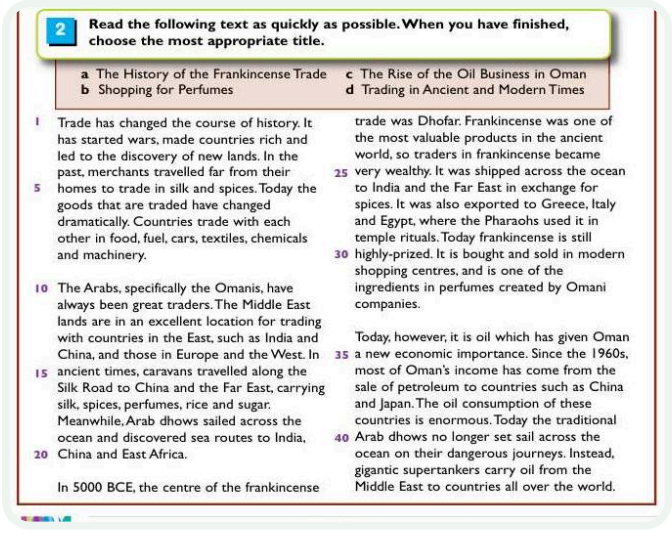
"Thousands of years ago," Grandfather said, "**merchants** travelled very far to **trade** in silk and spices. And in 5000 BCE, the centre of the frankincense trade was right here, in **Dhofar**."

"Who bought it?" asked Maryam.

"Many countries. We **exported** it to India, Greece, Italy and Egypt. People used it in their homes and in old **rituals**."

"Why did they come to Oman?" asked Salim.

"Because of our **location**. Oman's location is excellent for trading between East and West."



2 **Read the following text as quickly as possible. When you have finished, choose the most appropriate title.**

a The History of the Frankincense Trade
b Shopping for Perfumes
c The Rise of the Oil Business in Oman
d Trading in Ancient and Modern Times

Trade has changed the course of history. It has started wars, made countries rich and led to the discovery of new lands. In the past, merchants travelled far from their homes to trade in silk and spices. Today the goods that are traded have changed dramatically. Countries trade with each other in food, fuel, cars, textiles, chemicals and machinery.

The Arabs, specifically the Omanis, have always been great traders. The Middle East lands are in an excellent location for trading with countries in the East, such as India and China, and those in Europe and the West. In ancient times, caravans travelled along the Silk Road to China and the Far East, carrying silk, spices, perfumes, rice and sugar. Meanwhile, Arab dhows sailed across the ocean and discovered sea routes to India, China and East Africa.

In 5000 BCE, the centre of the frankincense trade was Dhofar. Frankincense was one of the most valuable products in the ancient world, so traders in frankincense became very wealthy. It was shipped across the ocean to India and the Far East in exchange for spices. It was also exported to Greece, Italy and Egypt, where the Pharaohs used it in temple rituals. Today frankincense is still highly-prized. It is bought and sold in modern shopping centres, and is one of the ingredients in perfumes created by Omani companies.

Today, however, it is oil which has given Oman a new economic importance. Since the 1960s, most of Oman's income has come from the sale of petroleum to countries such as China and Japan. The oil consumption of these countries is enormous. Today the traditional Arab dhows no longer set sail across the ocean on their dangerous journeys. Instead, gigantic supertankers carry oil from the Middle East to countries all over the world.

Reading text: trade in ancient and modern times

💡 Oman has always been a great trading nation: first frankincense, silk and spices, and today oil.

From dhows to supertankers

Grandfather pointed to a picture on the wall. It showed a wooden **dhow** with big white sails.

> "My grandfather sailed on this. Dhows were made of wood and moved with the wind."

Then Salim showed him a photo on his phone: an **enormous** ship at the port of Sohar.

> "And today we have supertankers," said Salim. "They are made of steel and have engines. They carry **oil**."

> "Yes. Since the 1960s most of Oman's income has come from oil. Trade changed **dramatically**, but Oman is still a trading country."

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Homework in the car

On the way home, Salim opened his English book. The task said: "Read the text **as quickly as possible** and choose the best title."

Salim started to read every word slowly.

> "Stop!" laughed Maryam. "That's not **skimming**. Skimming means reading quickly to find the **gist**, the main idea."

> "How do I do that?"

> "Don't read every word. Look at the headings, pictures and charts. Then read the **first sentence** of each paragraph. That is the **topic sentence**. It gives the main idea."

Salim tried it. In two minutes he had the answer: **"Trading in Ancient and Modern Times."**

> "And here's another question: find a word in paragraph 4 meaning 'very big'."

> "**Enormous**!" said Salim. "Like the supertanker."

Maryam smiled. — "Grandfather's box is small, but its story is enormous."

Retail therapy?

At the end of the unit, the title said "Retail Therapy".

> "What does that mean?" asked Salim.

> "**Retail therapy** means shopping to feel better," said Maryam. "But today we learned something better: trading is how Oman met the world."

📖 Words from the story

trade تجارة	**merchant** تاجر
frankincense اللبان	**export** يُصدِّر
ritual طقس / شعيرة	**location** موقع
enormous ضخم	**dramatically** بشكل كبير ومفاجئ
skimming القراءة السريعة لفهم الفكرة العامة	**retail therapy** التسوق لتحسين المزاج

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Merchants travelled far to trade in silk and spices, and Oman's location is excellent for trade between East and West
- ✔ In 5000 BCE the centre of the frankincense trade was Dhofar, and it was exported to India, Greece, Italy and Egypt
- ✔ Since the 1960s most of Oman's income has come from oil
- ✔ Dhows (wood, wind) were replaced by supertankers (steel, engines)
- ✔ Skimming means reading quickly for the gist: use headings and pictures and read the first sentence of each paragraph
- ✔ The topic sentence gives the main idea of a paragraph

🤔 Little questions

1. Where was the centre of the frankincense trade?
   Answer: Dhofar
2. What gave Oman new economic importance?
   Answer: oil
3. What does 'export' mean?
   Answer: sell to another country
4. What is skimming?
   Answer: reading quickly for the main idea

Lesson 1-2 · What's in a Name? (Past simple & past simple passive)

The Logo Detectives

A school story Theme 1: Retail Therapy

👥 Salim and his friend Ahmed, and their teacher Mr Khalid

Mr Khalid put a pair of trainers on his desk.

"Today you are **brand** detectives," he said. "Every **brand** has a story. Find it!"

The first clue: ownership

"**Branding** is not new," said Mr Khalid. "In ancient times, people **burned** marks on things to show who owned them."

"So a brand **was used** to show ownership," said Ahmed.

"Good! You used the **past simple passive**."

The second clue: Adidas

Salim looked at the trainers.

"Where does the name Adidas come from?"

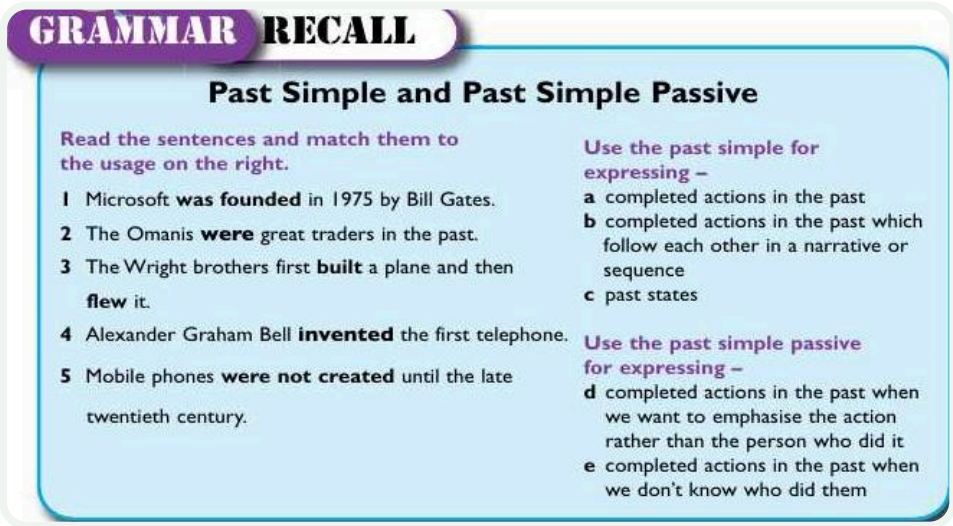
"Look it up," said Mr Khalid.

Salim read: "The name **was taken** from its **founder**, Adolf (Adi) Dassler."

"So, Adolf Dassler **founded** Adidas," said Ahmed. "That's active."

"And in the passive?" asked the teacher.

"Adidas **was founded** by Adolf Dassler."


GRAMMAR RECALL

Past Simple and Past Simple Passive

Read the sentences and match them to the usage on the right.

1 Microsoft **was founded** in 1975 by Bill Gates.
2 The Omanis **were** great traders in the past.
3 The Wright brothers first **built** a plane and then **flew** it.
4 Alexander Graham Bell **invented** the first telephone.
5 Mobile phones **were not created** until the late twentieth century.

Use the past simple for expressing –
a completed actions in the past
b completed actions in the past which follow each other in a narrative or sequence
c past states

Use the past simple passive for expressing –
d completed actions in the past when we want to emphasise the action rather than the person who did it
e completed actions in the past when we don't know who did them

Grammar Recall: past simple and past simple passive

💡 Past simple passive = was / were + past participle (made, built, chosen, founded).

The third clue: a car that didn't go

"Here's a funny one," said Mr Khalid. "The Chevrolet **Nova** sold badly in Latin America. Why?"

Nobody knew.

"Because in Spanish, 'no va' means **'it doesn't go'**! Who wants a car that doesn't go?"

Everybody laughed.

"And Coca-Cola **was named** after coca leaves and kola nuts."

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The Omani clue

"Now, an Omani **logo**," said the teacher. He showed a picture of a plane.

"Oman Air!" said Salim. "The logo shows a swirl of **frankincense** smoke."

"Right. A new logo **was chosen** in 2008. It shows our **heritage** and **identity**."

Ahmed wrote: "The logo was choose in 2008."

"Careful," said Mr Khalid. "**was choose** is wrong. We need the past participle: **was chosen**."

Past simple or passive?

"So when do we use each one?" asked Salim.

"The **past simple** is for completed actions: *The Omanis **were** great traders.* Or for actions in a story: *They **built** a plane and then **flew** it.*

The **passive** is for when the action is more important than the doer: *Microsoft **was founded** in 1975.* Or when we don't know who did it: *Mobile phones **were not created** until the late 20th century.*"

Ahmed corrected another sentence: "Adidas founded in 1949" became "Adidas **was founded** in 1949."

"Case closed!" said Salim.

📖 Words from the story

brand علامة تجارية	**logo** شعار
trademark علامة مسجلة	**consumer** مستهلك
identity هوية	**heritage** تراث
founder مؤسس	**passive** المبني للمجهول

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Branding was used in ancient times to show ownership
- ✔ Adidas was taken from the name of its founder, Adolf (Adi) Dassler, and Coca-Cola was named after coca leaves and kola nuts
- ✔ The Chevrolet Nova sold badly in Spanish-speaking countries because 'no va' means 'it doesn't go'
- ✔ Oman Air's new logo (2008) shows a swirl of frankincense smoke
- ✔ Past simple: completed actions and events in a story
- ✔ Past simple passive (was/were + past participle): when the action matters more or we don't know the doer

🤔 Little questions

1. Where does the name Adidas come from?
   Answer: its founder Adolf (Adi) Dassler
2. What does Oman Air's logo show?
   Answer: a swirl of frankincense smoke
3. Form of the past passive?
   Answer: was/were + past participle
4. Why didn't the Nova sell well?
   Answer: 'no va' means 'it doesn't go' in Spanish



Lesson 1-3 · Shop Till You Drop (Vocabulary & collocations)

Aunt Huda's Shopping Bags

A family story Theme 1: Retail Therapy

👥 Maryam, her aunt Huda, and her mother

Every weekend, Aunt Huda came home with new shopping bags. Shoes, bags, perfumes... She had so many things that she didn't need.

One day Maryam read an article for her English class. It was about two women, Vanessa and Katy. They were **shopaholics**.

> "Mum, what is a shopaholic?"

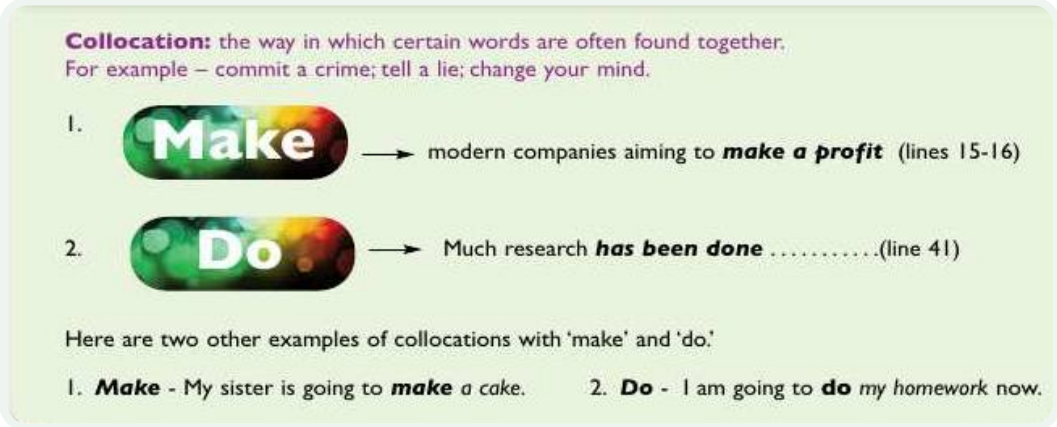
> "Someone who is **addicted** to shopping."

Maryam looked at Aunt Huda's bags and said nothing.

The article

The article said that shopping was Vanessa and Katy's greatest **passion**. They were **affluent**, they had plenty of money, but they bought things they did not need. Their shopping was **compulsive**: they could not control it. Their spending was **excessive**.

> "Shopping can make you feel better for a short time," Maryam read. "It is a short-term **consolation**. But it can create more problems than it solves."



Collocations with make and do

> 💡 Shopping can lift your mood for a short time, but over-spending can lead to debt and bankruptcy.

Guessing from context

Maryam didn't know the word **afflict**. She didn't open the dictionary. She read the sentence again: "This problem **afflicts** many **consumers**."

> "It means it affects them in a bad way," she guessed. She was right! Guessing from **context** is a great skill.

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A gentle talk

That evening, Aunt Huda showed them a new handbag.

> "Aunty," said Maryam carefully, "did you know that credit card debts can lead to **bankruptcy**?"

Aunt Huda laughed. — "I **made a mistake**, didn't I? I bought three bags this month."

> "Not 'did a mistake'," smiled Maryam. "We say **make a mistake**."

Make or do?

Maryam taught her aunt a game. She said a word, and her aunt said "make" or "do".

> "A promise?" — "**Make** a promise."

> "Homework?" — "**Do** homework."

> "A profit?" — "**Make** a profit."

> "The shopping?" — "**Do** the shopping."

> "Research?" — "**Do** research."

These are **collocations**: words that often go together. Learn them as one unit.

Make: a profit, a mistake, a promise, a cake, an effort, an impression, dinner, a joke.

Do: research, homework, your duty, a favour, the shopping, the washing-up, some exercise, a crossword.

> "Now **do me a favour**," said Aunt Huda. "Help me return two of these bags!"

📖 Words from the story

shopaholic
مدمن التسوق

compulsive
قهري لا يمكن السيطرة عليه

consumer
مستهلك

excessive
مفرط

afflict
يصيب / يؤثر سلبًا

consolation
مواساة

affluent
ثري

bankruptcy
إفلاس

passion
شغف

collocation
متلازمة لفظية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ A shopaholic is someone who is addicted to shopping
- ✔ Vanessa and Katy were career women whose greatest passion was shopping, and they bought things they didn't need
- ✔ Shopping can be a short-term fix but can create more problems, and credit card debts can lead to bankruptcy
- ✔ Guess the meaning of new words from context
- ✔ Collocations: make a profit/mistake/promise/effort
- ✔ do research/homework/a favour/the shopping

🤔 Little questions

1. What is a shopaholic?
   Answer: someone addicted to shopping
2. What does affluent mean?
   Answer: having plenty of money
3. make or do: ___ a favour
   Answer: do
4. make or do: ___ a promise
   Answer: make

Lesson 1-4 · Malls and Markets (Listening & speaking)

Two Ways to Buy a Gift

A dialogue story · Theme 1: Retail Therapy

👥 Salim and his cousin Faisal, choosing a gift for Grandmother

It was Grandmother's birthday. Salim and Faisal wanted to buy her a gift.

"Let's go to the **mall**," said Faisal. "I **love** shopping there."

"I'**d rather go** to the **souq**," said Salim. "I **enjoy bargaining**."

They couldn't agree, so they visited both.

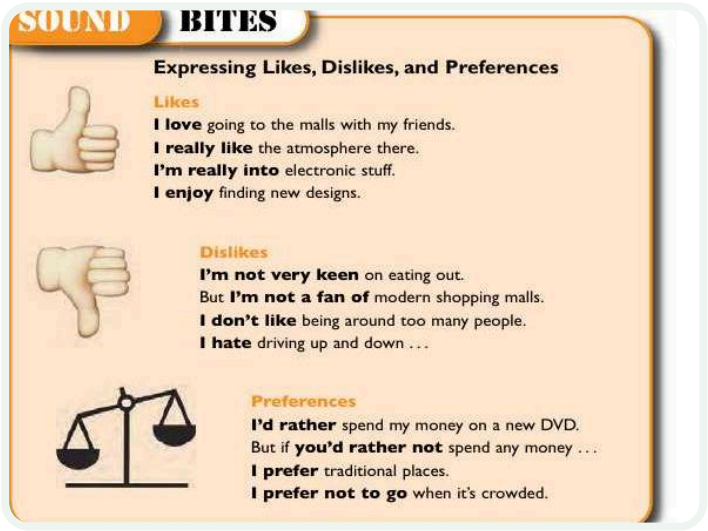
Before they went

In the car, Salim said:

"In class, we learned to **predict** before listening. Let's predict what we will see."

"At the mall: bright lights, coffee bars, **wide walkways**, top brand names, latest fashions, and easy parking."

"And at the souq: **narrow passages** with **tiny shops**, friendly shopkeepers, **bargaining**, and **old-fashioned charm**."



Soundbites: expressing likes, dislikes and preferences

💡 Before you listen, think about the information you are likely to hear. This helps you guess the vocabulary.

At the mall

The mall was big and cool. Faisal was happy.

> "I'**m really into** electronic stuff," he said, looking at the new phones.

Salim looked at the crowds. — "I'**m not a fan of** crowded shopping malls."

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At the souq

Then they went to Muttrah Souq. The **atmosphere** was different: the smell of frankincense, the colours, the voices.

An old shopkeeper showed them a silver box.

> "Ten rials," he said.

> "Seven?" said Salim with a smile.

> "Eight, for you, my son."

Faisal laughed. — "OK, I admit it. **Bargaining** is fun!"

The language of likes and dislikes

On the way home, Salim made a list:

Likes: I love… / I really like… / I'm really into… / I enjoy…

Dislikes: I'm not very keen on… / I'm not a fan of… / I don't like… / I hate…

Preferences: I'd rather + verb / I prefer + noun or -ing

> "Be careful," said Salim. "After **I'd rather**, use the base verb: *I'd rather **go***, not *I'd rather to go*. After **I enjoy**, use -ing: *I enjoy **shopping***, not *I enjoy to shop*."

Grandmother loved the silver box.

> "Where did you buy it?"

> "In the souq," said Faisal. "Next time, I'd rather go there first!"

📖 Words from the story

souq سوق تقليدي	**mall** مركز تجاري
bargaining المساومة	**prediction** التوقع
preference تفضيل	**walkway** ممر
old-fashioned charm سحر قديم	**atmosphere** جو

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Malls have coffee bars, bright lights, wide walkways, top brand names, latest fashions and easy parking
- ✔ Souqs have narrow passages with tiny shops, friendly shopkeepers, bargaining and old-fashioned charm
- ✔ Predict before you listen to guess the vocabulary more easily
- ✔ Likes: I love / I'm really into
- ✔ Dislikes: I'm not a fan of / I'm not very keen on
- ✔ Preferences: I'd rather + base verb, I prefer + noun or -ing
- ✔ After I enjoy use -ing: I enjoy shopping

🤔 Little questions

1. Name two features of a souq
   Answer: bargaining, tiny shops
2. Name two features of a mall
   Answer: wide walkways, brand names
3. What should you do before listening?
   Answer: predict
4. Complete: I'm really ___ electronic stuff.
   Answer: into



Lesson 1-5 · Adverts: Appealing or Appalling? (Writing an evaluation)

The Juice Advert

A school project story | Theme 1: Retail Therapy

👥 Maryam and her friend Shaima, making an advert for a school project

Maryam and Shaima had a project: make an advert for a new mango juice, and then write an **evaluation** of another group's advert.

Why advertise?

"First," said Shaima, "what is the **purpose** of advertising?"

"To **inform**, to **persuade**, to **compare**, and to **entertain**," said Maryam.

The slogan

"Now we need a **slogan**: a short, catchy phrase."

"Like BMW: *The Ultimate Driving Machine*," said Shaima.

They thought for a long time. Then Maryam wrote: **"Simply the best taste in Oman."**

"Is it good?"

"Yes. It's short, positive and easy to remember."

The right adjectives

They chose adjectives carefully:

Food and drink: tasty, delicious, **nutritious**.

They didn't use **fragrant** or **luxurious**. Those are for perfume!

"And for shoes?" asked Shaima.

"Comfortable, stylish, fashionable, cool. For a car: powerful, fast, smooth, safe. And general words: **long-lasting**, **cost-saving**."

Look at the eight photos of products. Which words might be used to advertise each product? Make a list of the products in your exercise book and match the words to the products.

Note: Some words can be used for more than one product.

1. tasty	5. nutritious	9. powerful	13. refreshing
2. fragrant	6. stylish	10. fashionable	14. luxurious
3. comfortable	7. long-lasting	11. delicious	15. cost-saving
4. fast	8. cool	12. smooth	16. safe

Adjectives used in advertising

> 💡 A good advert has a clear purpose, a short memorable slogan and adjectives that suit the product.

❁ ❁ ❁

Evaluating another advert

Next, they watched an advert from another group. It said: "Drink this juice and you will never get ill!"

> "That's **misleading**," said Maryam. "It gives false information."

> "So is it **appealing** or **appalling**?"

> "The pictures are appealing: bright and attractive. But the message is appalling!"

Shaima wrote: "The advert is very appalling, I like it."

> "No!" laughed Maryam. "**Appalling** is negative. Use **appealing** for positive."

Writing the evaluation

They organised their evaluation like this:

Introduction: the product and where they saw it.

Description: the picture, the slogan and the language.

Strengths and weaknesses: what is good and what is weak.

Conclusion: their final opinion: appealing or appalling?

The teacher gave them full marks and said: — "Your evaluation is like your slogan: simply the best!"

📖 Words from the story

appealing جذاب	**appalling** مروع / سيئ جدًا
slogan شعار دعائي	**persuade** يُقنع
misleading مضلل	**fragrant** عطِر
long-lasting يدوم طويلًا	**cost-saving** موفر
luxurious فاخر	**nutritious** مغذٍّ

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Advertising aims to inform, persuade, compare or entertain
- ✔ A good slogan is short and memorable
- ✔ Food: tasty, delicious, nutritious
- ✔ perfume: fragrant, luxurious
- ✔ clothes: comfortable, stylish
- ✔ car: powerful, safe
- ✔ Adverts can be misleading if they hide information or give false information
- ✔ Evaluation: introduction, description, strengths and weaknesses, conclusion with your opinion
- ✔ Appealing is positive and appalling is negative

🤔 Little questions

1. Give two purposes of advertising
   Answer: to inform, to persuade
2. What is a slogan?
   Answer: a short catchy phrase used in advertising
3. Adjective for food
   Answer: tasty / delicious
4. What is a misleading ad?
   Answer: one that gives false information

Lesson 1-6 · Across Cultures: Egypt & Ethics and Advertising

A Postcard from Cairo

A letter story · Theme 1: Retail Therapy

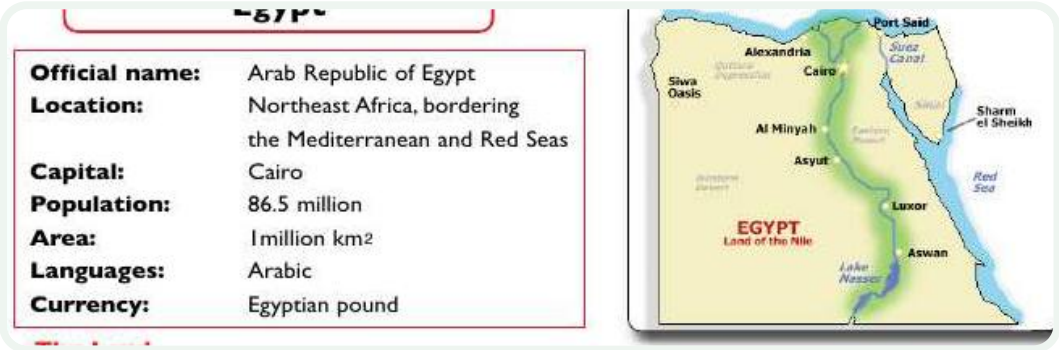
👥 Salim, and his uncle Nasser who works in Egypt

Uncle Nasser's postcard

Dear Salim,

Greetings from **Cairo**! It is a huge city with about 18 million people. Egypt's **population** is 86.5 million, and **99%** of the people live along the **Nile**.

Do you know why? Because the water makes the land green and fertile. The Nile is 6,650 km long, the longest river in the world. It flows into the **Mediterranean Sea**, not the Red Sea!



Egypt fact file

💡 Egypt is where Africa and Asia meet, and the Nile (6,650 km) is the longest river in the world.

Salim's reply

Dear Uncle,

Thank you! In class we read the Egypt fact file. The language is Arabic and the **currency** is the Egyptian pound. Is it true that **Al-Azhar University** is about 1,000 years old?

Uncle Nasser's second letter

Dear Salim,

Yes! Al-Azhar was founded in about 970 CE. It is one of the oldest Islamic universities. And did you know that **Naguib Mahfouz** was the first Arab to win the Nobel Prize for Literature, in 1988?

Egypt's economy depends on agriculture, oil and gas, the **Suez Canal** and tourism. The **Aswan High Dam** produces electricity.

❁ ❁ ❁

Salim's letter about ethics

Dear Uncle,

Today we read about **ethics in advertising**. Adverts must be **truthful**. If an advert is not **ethical**, the company gets negative **publicity**.

We learned a Latin phrase: **'Caveat emptor'**. It means **'let the buyer beware'**.

In the past, adverts said things like "Four out of five doctors recommend...". Today that is not allowed without proof. Some medicine adverts must also tell people about **side-effects**. And some adverts use **mock-ups** instead of the real product. For example, the ice cream in a photo may not be real ice cream!

The government **regulates** advertising to protect people.

Uncle Nasser's last letter

Dear Salim,

I'm proud of you. In Cairo's markets, I always remember 'caveat emptor'.

Now, make a **Cultural Comparison** box. Compare Oman with Egypt: we have the sea and the mountains; Egypt has the Nile. Both countries have a long history of trade.

See you soon,

Uncle Nasser

📖 Words from the story

population عدد السكان	**currency** عملة
ethical أخلاقي	**publicity** دعاية
mock-up نموذج مقلّد	**regulate** ينظّم
side-effects آثار جانبية	**literacy** محو الأمية / القدرة على القراءة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Egypt: capital Cairo (about 18 million people), population 86.5 million, 99% live along the Nile
- ✔ The Nile (6,650 km) is the longest river and flows into the Mediterranean Sea
- ✔ Al-Azhar (about 970 CE) is one of the oldest Islamic universities, and Naguib Mahfouz won the Nobel Prize in 1988
- ✔ Egypt's economy: agriculture, oil and gas, the Suez Canal and tourism
- ✔ the Aswan High Dam produces electricity
- ✔ Ads must be truthful
- ✔ unethical ads cause negative publicity
- ✔ 'Caveat emptor' means 'let the buyer beware'

🤔 Little questions

1. Capital of Egypt?
   Answer: Cairo
2. Length of the Nile?
   Answer: 6,650 km
3. Who won the Nobel Prize in 1988?
   Answer: Naguib Mahfouz
4. Meaning of Caveat emptor?
   Answer: let the buyer beware

Lesson 2-1 · Goodbye, School! (Reading speed)

The Last Day

A diary story Theme 2: Starting University

👥 Salim on his last day of school, and his cousin Faisal, a university student

Salim's diary, last day of school

Today was my last day at school. I felt happy and sad at the same time. Next year I will start university. It is a big **transition**, a big change. To be honest, I feel **apprehensive**: worried and a little afraid.

In the evening, my cousin Faisal visited. He is at university now. I asked him:

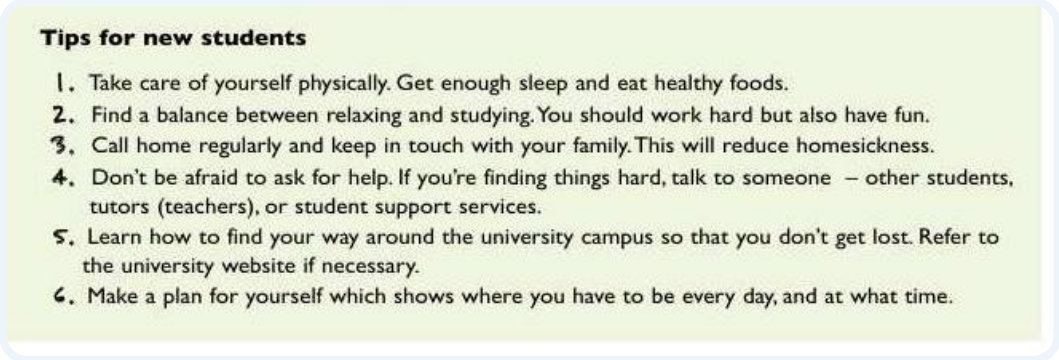
> "Were you scared in your first year?"

> "Of course! Everybody is. But there are simple **tips** to help you **cope**."

Faisal's tips

Faisal wrote a list for me:

1. **Take care of yourself**: sleep well and eat healthy food.
2. **Balance** relaxing and studying.
3. **Call home** regularly. It helps if you feel **homesick**.
4. **Ask for help** from other students, tutors or support services.
5. **Learn your way around the campus**.
6. **Make a plan** and manage your time. **Prioritise** urgent tasks, and don't miss a **deadline**.
7. **Don't be hard on yourself**. Learn from your mistakes.
8. **Join clubs and societies** to make friends, especially if you are shy.



Tips for new students

1. Take care of yourself physically. Get enough sleep and eat healthy foods.
2. Find a balance between relaxing and studying. You should work hard but also have fun.
3. Call home regularly and keep in touch with your family. This will reduce homesickness.
4. Don't be afraid to ask for help. If you're finding things hard, talk to someone – other students, tutors (teachers), or student support services.
5. Learn how to find your way around the university campus so that you don't get lost. Refer to the university website if necessary.
6. Make a plan for yourself which shows where you have to be every day, and at what time.

Tips for new students

> 💡 It is normal to feel apprehensive about university. Look after yourself, balance study and fun, ask for help and make new friends.

❁ ❁ ❁

Reading speed

Before he left, Faisal gave me a challenge.

> "At university you will read a lot. You must read fast. Read this article and time yourself."

I read 600 words in 3 minutes.

> "**Reading speed** = number of words ÷ minutes," said Faisal. "So 600 ÷ 3 = 200 words per minute. Good!"

> "But I didn't understand every word."

> "That's fine! You were **reading for gist**. Don't stop at every new word. Guess from context. Don't check every word in the dictionary while you skim."

New words

In the article I found a word meaning 'worried and a little afraid': **apprehensive**. And **campus** means the university land and buildings.

The end of the diary

Faisal said: — "University can be challenging and you may feel stress. But you develop **confidence** and **independence**. Many people think university is the best time of their lives. Your **prospects** will grow, and the experience is **rewarding**."

I closed my diary and smiled. Goodbye, school. Hello, future!

📖 Words from the story

transition انتقال / مرحلة تحول	**apprehensive** قلق ومتخوف
homesick مشتاق إلى البيت	**campus** الحرم الجامعي
prioritise يرتب حسب الأهمية	**deadline** موعد نهائي
emotions مشاعر	**independence** استقلالية
prospects فرص مستقبلية	**rewarding** مُجزٍ

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Starting university is a major transition, and it is normal to feel apprehensive
- ✔ Tips: take care of yourself, balance relaxing and studying, call home, ask for help, learn the campus
- ✔ Make a plan, prioritise urgent tasks, don't be hard on yourself, and join clubs to make friends
- ✔ University develops confidence and independence and can be the best time of your life
- ✔ Reading speed = number of words ÷ minutes
- ✔ Read for gist: don't stop at every new word, guess from context

🤔 Little questions

1. What is 'homesick'?
   Answer: feeling sad because you miss your home
2. What does 'prioritise' mean?
   Answer: put things in order of importance
3. How can you reduce homesickness?
   Answer: call home regularly
4. What does 'campus' mean?
   Answer: university land and buildings



Lesson 2-2 · Coping with Change (Past perfect)

Faisal's Terrible Morning

A funny story Theme 2: Starting University

👥 Faisal, a first-year student at Sultan Qaboos University, and his friend Abdullah

Faisal woke up and looked at his phone. It was 8:30! His first lecture **had started** at 8:00.

He **had overslept**. He **had forgotten** to set his alarm.

He ran to the bus stop, but the bus **had** already **left**.

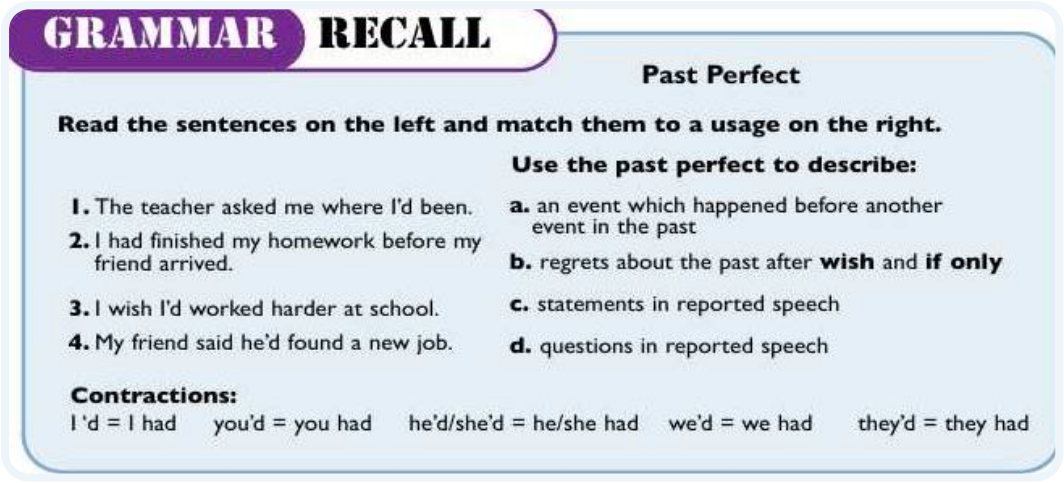
A lift

Abdullah stopped his car.

"Faisal! What happened?"

"I overslept and missed the bus!"

"Get in. I'll give you a **lift**."



GRAMMAR RECALL

Past Perfect

Read the sentences on the left and match them to a usage on the right.

1. The teacher asked me where I'd been.
2. I had finished my homework before my friend arrived.
3. I wish I'd worked harder at school.
4. My friend said he'd found a new job.

Use the past perfect to describe:

a. an event which happened before another event in the past

b. regrets about the past after **wish** and **if only**

c. statements in reported speech

d. questions in reported speech

Contractions:

I 'd = I had you'd = you had he'd/she'd = he/she had we'd = we had they'd = they had

Grammar Recall: the past perfect

💡 Past perfect = had + past participle. Use it for an action that happened before another past action.

Which came first?

In the car, Abdullah, who was an English major, laughed.

"Listen to your story: *The bus **had left** before you **arrived**.* Two past actions. Which came first?"

"The bus left first."

"So the first action is in the **past perfect**: **had + past participle**. The second one is in the past simple."

"Like: *I **had finished** my homework before my friend **arrived**?*"

"Exactly. But use the past perfect only when you need to show which past action came first."

"And **I'd**?"

"It's a **contraction**: *I'd* = *I had*, *she'd* = *she had*, *they'd* = *they had*."

❁ ❁ ❁

Regrets

Faisal sighed. — "I **wish** I studied more last year."

"No," said Abdullah. "For a **regret** about the past, use **wish** or **if only** + past perfect: *I wish I **had studied** more last year.*"

"OK. **If only** I **hadn't wasted** so much time! And I wish **I'd listened** to my mother's advice. She told me to go to bed early."

Reported speech

In class, the teacher asked Faisal where he **had been**.

After class, Faisal phoned his mother.

"What did the teacher say?" she asked.

"She asked me where **I'd been**. I said I **had overslept**."

Later, his friend told him some news. Faisal reported it to Abdullah:

"Ahmed said he **had found** a new job."

"Not 'he has found'," smiled Abdullah. "In **reported speech**, we move back: *has found* becomes *had found*."

The next morning

The next morning Faisal's alarm rang at 6:00. He was at the bus stop at 7:00.

"Ten minutes before the bus **had arrived**," he said proudly.

"Hmm," said Abdullah. "*I **had arrived** ten minutes before the bus came.* That's better!"

📖 Words from the story

oversleep
يستغرق في النوم

cope
يتأقلم / يتعامل

regret
ندم

reported speech
الكلام المنقول

contraction
اختصار

lift
توصيلة بالسيارة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Faisal, a first-year student at SQU, overslept and missed the bus
- ✔ Past perfect = had + past participle
- ✔ contractions: I'd = I had
- ✔ Use it for an event before another past event: I had finished my homework before my friend arrived
- ✔ Regrets: wish / if only + past perfect: I wish I had studied more
- ✔ Reported speech: He said he had found a new job
- ✔ She asked me where I'd been
- ✔ Use the past perfect only to show which past action came first

🤔 Little questions

1. Form of the past perfect?
   Answer: had + past participle
2. Complete: If only I ___ (not waste) time.
   Answer: hadn't wasted
3. What does I'd mean in 'I'd finished'?
   Answer: I had
4. Why was Faisal late?
   Answer: he overslept and missed the bus



Lesson 2-3 · Studying Abroad (Vocabulary: lexical fields)

A Suitcase Full of Words

A family story | Theme 2: Starting University

👥 Maryam, who will study in the UK, her mother, and her brother Salim

Maryam got a scholarship to study in the UK. She was excited, but also a little **scared**.

"Studying **abroad** is more than getting a **degree**," said her mother. "You will **adapt** to a new **culture** and meet new people."

Getting ready

Maryam made a plan:

Talk to people who studied in the same town or university.

Read the university website: students, **accommodation**, activities and support services.

Learn about the town: is it big or small? On the coast or inland? What about transport and attractions?

"Accommodation means places to stay," Salim said. "And remember the spelling: double **c**, double **m**!"

1	**improving** (line 3) (a) changing	(b) making worse	(c) making better
2	**scary** (line 6) (a) difficult	(b) frightening	(c) interesting
3	**accommodation** (line 16) (a) hotels and hostels	(b) buildings	(c) places to stay
4	**reduce** (line 27) (a) make less	(b) prevent	(c) deal with
5	**issues** (line 30) (a) experiences	(b) discussions	(c) problems
6	**coping** (line 32) (a) behaving	(b) living	(c) managing
7	**influence** (line 33) (a) show	(b) affect	(c) control

Guessing meanings of words from the text

Reducing homesickness

"What if I miss home?" asked Maryam.

"Here's how to **reduce** homesickness," said Mother. "**Involve your family** in planning your trip. **Sort out any issues** at home before you go. And **start doing things for yourself** now: washing, ironing, cooking!"

"Cooking?" Maryam laughed. — "OK, teach me how to make harees!"

"And keep a **positive attitude**. It will **influence** how you behave. You will make friends more easily."

> 💡 Prepare before you go, reduce homesickness, and keep a positive attitude: it influences how you behave.

❁ ❁ ❁

Guessing from context

Maryam read a university leaflet. She didn't know the word **improving** in line 3: "The city is **improving** its parks every year."

"Don't open the dictionary yet," said Salim. "Use the words around it. The city does something good to its parks every year…"

"Making them better!"

"Right. Use the **context** first."

A suitcase of words

"Now, a trick to remember new words," said Salim. "**Group** them into topics. These are called **lexical fields**. Words that go together are easier to remember."

He drew a suitcase and wrote inside it:

Cities: buildings, transport, population, shopping, traffic.

University: campus, degree, accommodation, lecture, tutor.

Feelings: scary, homesick, positive, apprehensive.

Maryam took a photo of the suitcase.

"I'll pack my words with my clothes!"

📖 Words from the story

accommodation سكن	**abroad** في الخارج
adapt يتكيف	**reduce** يُقلل
issue مشكلة / قضية	**coping** التعامل والتأقلم
influence يؤثر	**scary** مخيف
positive attitude موقف إيجابي	**degree** شهادة جامعية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Studying abroad means adapting to a new culture and meeting new people, not only getting a degree
- ✔ Get ready: talk to people who studied there, read the university website, learn about the town
- ✔ Reduce homesickness: involve your family, sort out issues, do things for yourself
- ✔ A positive attitude influences how you behave
- ✔ Guess the meaning of a new word from the words around it
- ✔ Group words into lexical fields: they are easier to remember

🤔 Little questions

1. Meaning of 'accommodation'?
   Answer: places to stay
2. Meaning of 'reduce'?
   Answer: make less
3. Meaning of 'scary'?
   Answer: frightening
4. Why group words?
   Answer: they are easier to remember

Lesson 2-4 · A Helping Hand (Asking for clarification)

The Rovers' Welcome

A university story | Theme 2: Starting University

👥 Salim on his first day at SQU, and Hamad, a volunteer from the SQU Rovers

On his first day at Sultan Qaboos University, Salim stood in front of a big map. He was lost.

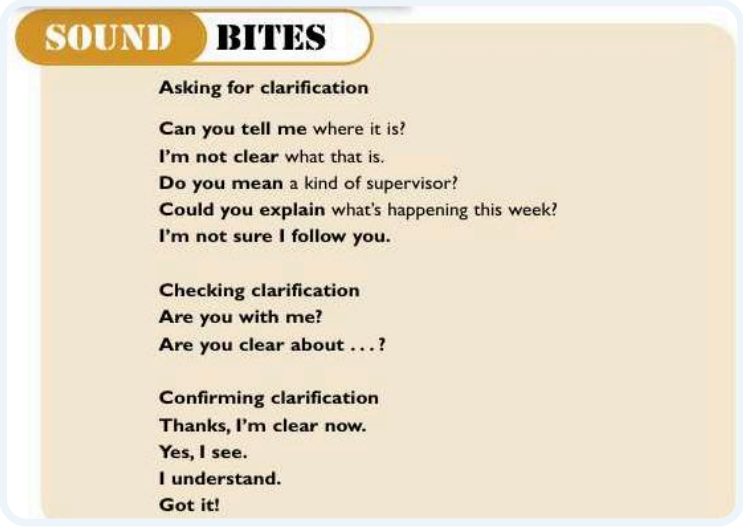
A smiling student came to him. His T-shirt said "**SQU Rovers**".

"Hi, I'm Hamad. Can I help?"

Who are the Rovers?

"Who are the Rovers?" asked Salim.

"We're an active group of students in different years. There are over 100 male and over 30 female Rovers. We organise activities and trips all year. At the start of the first semester, we help new students on the **Foundation Programme**."



Soundbites: asking for clarification

💡 The SQU Rovers are students who help new students and organise activities and trips.

Asking for clarification

"First, you have a **placement test** tomorrow at 9."

Salim didn't understand.

"**Could you explain** what a placement test is?"

"Sure. It's an exam to find your English level."

> "**Do you mean** it decides my class?"

> "Exactly."

Salim remembered his teacher's advice: *'Could you explain...?' is more polite than 'What?'*

❁ ❁ ❁

Checking and confirming

Hamad showed him the map.

> "The test is in building 5, next to the library. Then you go to the **co-ordinator**'s office to collect your timetable. **Are you with me?**"

> "**I'm not sure I follow you.** Where is the co-ordinator's office?"

> "Second floor, room 210. **Are you clear about** it now?"

> "Yes, **I see**. **Thanks, I'm clear now.** **Got it!**"

Common problems

Walking together, Hamad said:

> "New students often have the same problems: managing on their own, finding their way around, missing their family, and finding rooms."

> "Can you tell me where is it, the canteen?"

Hamad smiled. — "We say: *Can you tell me where **it is**?* In indirect questions, the verb goes after the subject."

> "Can you tell me where it is?"

> "Behind building 3. Let me show you."

At the end of the day, Salim joined the Rovers as a **volunteer**. Next year, he would be the one helping.

📖 Words from the story

clarification
توضيح

placement test
اختبار تحديد المستوى

Foundation Programme
البرنامج التأسيسي

co-ordinator
منسق

volunteer
متطوع

supervisor
مشرف

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The SQU Rovers are an active group of students (over 100 male and over 30 female) who organise activities and help new students
- ✔ New students' problems: managing on their own, finding the way, missing family, finding rooms
- ✔ Asking for clarification: Could you explain...? / Do you mean...? / I'm not sure I follow you
- ✔ Checking: Are you with me? / Are you clear about...?
- ✔ Confirming: Thanks, I'm clear now. / I see. / Got it!
- ✔ Indirect questions: Can you tell me where it is?

🤔 Little questions

1. Who are the SQU Rovers?
   Answer: a group of students who help others and organise activities
2. Phrase to check understanding
   Answer: Are you with me?
3. Phrase to confirm
   Answer: Got it!
4. What is a placement test?
   Answer: an exam to find a student's level

Lesson 2-5 · A Letter to a Teacher (Writing: informal letter)

Dear Miss Salma

A letter story Theme 2: Starting University

👥 Maryam, a new university student, and her course co-ordinator

The co-ordinator's letter

On her first day, Maryam got a letter from her course **co-ordinator**. It welcomed the new students, gave them some advice, and asked them to write a letter to their new English teacher, Miss Salma, about themselves.

> "What is the **purpose** of this letter?" Maryam asked her friend.

> "All of them: to welcome us, to give advice, and to ask us to write."

Making notes

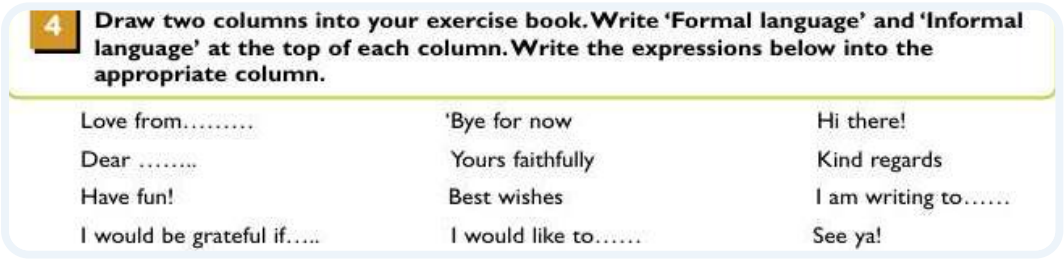
Maryam didn't start writing immediately. First, she **made notes** under headings. She used **key words**, not full sentences:

My family: 2 brothers, 1 sister – Muscat

My spare time: reading, swimming

Learning English: love films – grammar difficult

My plans for the future: study engineering – SQU – work in Oman



4 Draw two columns into your exercise book. Write 'Formal language' and 'Informal language' at the top of each column. Write the expressions below into the appropriate column.

Love from.....	'Bye for now	Hi there!
Dear	Yours faithfully	Kind regards
Have fun!	Best wishes	I am writing to.....
I would be grateful if.....	I would like to.....	See ya!

Formal and informal expressions

💡 Plan first: make notes with key words under headings, then write a draft, then proof-read and edit.

Formal or informal?

> "How should I start?" Maryam wondered.

She looked at a list:

Formal: Dear..., Yours faithfully, I would be grateful if..., I would like to..., I am writing to...

Informal: Hi there!, Love from..., 'Bye for now, Have fun!, See ya!

Neutral: Best wishes, Kind regards

> "A letter to a teacher should be friendly but polite," she decided. "No 'See ya!'"

❁ ❁ ❁

The draft

Maryam wrote her **draft**:

Dear Miss Salma,

My name is Maryam and I am from Muscat. I have two brothers and one sister. In my spare time I enjoy reading and swimming.

I love learning English, especially from films, but I find grammar a little difficult.

In the future I would like to study engineering and work in Oman.

I am looking forward to your classes.

Best wishes,

Maryam

Proof-reading

Then she gave it to her friend to **proof-read**. Her friend checked the spelling, grammar and punctuation. "You wrote *I enjoy reading*, not *I enjoy to read*. Good!"

Maryam **edited** the letter and wrote the final copy.

A week later, Miss Salma wrote back: *"Thank you, Maryam! A clear and friendly letter. I look forward to helping you with grammar!"*

📖 Words from the story

purpose غرض	**formal** رسمي
informal غير رسمي	**proof-read** يراجع ويصحح
draft مسودة	**edit** يحرر ويصحح
key words كلمات مفتاحية	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The co-ordinator's letter welcomed new students, gave advice and asked them to write to their English teacher
- ✔ Make notes under headings: family, spare time, learning English, plans for the future
- ✔ Use key words in notes, not complete sentences
- ✔ Formal: Dear..., Yours faithfully, I would like to...
- ✔ Informal: Hi there!, See ya!
- ✔ Neutral: Best wishes, Kind regards
- ✔ A letter to a teacher should be friendly but polite
- ✔ Write a draft, then proof-read and edit

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the purpose of the co-ordinator's letter?
   Answer: all of the above: welcome, give advice, ask students to write
2. Formal ending
   Answer: Yours faithfully
3. Informal greeting
   Answer: Hi there!
4. What is a draft?
   Answer: writing not in its final form

Lesson 2-6 · Across Cultures: France & Rumaitha Al Busaidi

From Muscat to the Ice

An interview story Theme 2: Starting University

👥 Maryam, who writes a magazine page about France and about Rumaitha Al Busaidi

For the school magazine, Maryam prepared a page about two topics: **France**, and an inspiring Omani woman, **Rumaitha Al Busaidi**.

Part 1: France fact file

Maryam wrote:

Capital: Paris. **Population**: 67 million. **Currency**: Euro.

France is the largest country in Western Europe, famous for Paris, the Eiffel Tower and its food.

Mont Blanc (4,810 m) is the highest point in Western Europe.

Main rivers: Seine, Loire, Garonne, Rhône.

The French **Revolution** began on 14 July 1789, when a crowd stormed the Bastille.

Fast trains (TGV) and the Channel Tunnel link France and England.

Official name:	French Republic
Location:	Western Europe
Capital:	Paris
Population:	67 million
Area:	551,500 km²
Languages:	French
Currency:	Euro



France fact file

Part 2: Preserving the Antarctic

Then Maryam read the interview with Rumaitha in her book. She wrote it as questions and answers. Interviews are easy to read this way: **read the questions first** to find information quickly.

Where did you study? — Environmental science, in the Netherlands.

What was the expedition? — It was the '2041' **expedition**, started by Robert Swan, to preserve the **Antarctic**.

How did you prepare? — I trained for a whole year, even in a freezer at minus 20 degrees, to **acclimatise**.

How many people went? — There were 88 participants from 28 countries.

> 💡 Rumaitha's advice: 'Build your career around what you love.'

❁ ❁ ❁

A common mistake

Maryam's friend read the page and said: "Wow, she went to the Arctic!"

"No," said Maryam. "The **Antarctic**, the South Pole region. The Arctic is the North."

The advice

At the end of the page, Maryam wrote Rumaitha's advice in big letters:

"Build your career around what you love. That's the secret to a successful career."

"I think she is a true **environmentalist**," said Maryam. "She followed her **passion**, even to the coldest place on Earth."

Her friend looked at the photo of the ice and said: — "And it looks **terrifying**!"

"Terrifying, but beautiful," smiled Maryam.

📖 Words from the story

expedition بعثة / رحلة استكشافية	**environmentalist** ناشط بيئي
passion شغف	**Antarctic** القارة القطبية الجنوبية
sponsor راعٍ / ممول	**acclimatise** يتأقلم مع المناخ
revolution ثورة	**terrifying** مرعب

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ France: capital Paris, population 67 million, currency Euro, largest country in Western Europe
- ✔ Mont Blanc (4,810 m) is the highest point in Western Europe, and the main rivers are the Seine, Loire, Garonne and Rhône
- ✔ The French Revolution began on 14 July 1789 with the storming of the Bastille
- ✔ Rumaitha Al Busaidi studied environmental science in the Netherlands and joined the '2041' expedition to the Antarctic
- ✔ She trained for a whole year, and there were 88 participants from 28 countries
- ✔ Her advice: Build your career around what you love

🤔 Little questions

1. Capital of France?
   Answer: Paris
2. Highest point in Western Europe?
   Answer: Mont Blanc
3. Where did Rumaitha study?
   Answer: the Netherlands
4. How long did she train?
   Answer: a whole year



Lesson 3-1 · A Warm Welcome (Reading for specific information)

Six Visitors, One Country

A travel story Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

👥 Salim, who works as a summer volunteer at a tourist information desk in Muscat

In 2015, the New York Times listed **Oman** among the top **destinations** in the world. That summer, Salim volunteered at a tourist information desk at Muscat airport. Every day he met visitors from different countries. On his last day, he wrote about six of them.

Max from Germany

Max loved **adventure**: camping, diving and **trekking**. He wanted to **trek**, to go on a long, difficult walk. Salim sent him to **Jebel Shams** and to **Wadi Ghul**, the 'Grand Canyon of Oman'. A **canyon** is a long, deep valley with steep sides.

> "**Awesome**!" Max said when he came back.

Yoshi from Japan

Yoshi loved the **variety of scenery**: mountains, beaches, deserts, and the green forests in **Dhofar**.

Donna from the UK

Donna loved **history**. She visited the forts of **Nizwa**, **Bahla** and **Jibreen**.

2 **Read the text below and check the meaning of the words and phrases in bold. Use a dictionary to help you.**

The **hospitality industry** is one of the world's largest and fastest growing industries. The size and growth of this industry makes it a huge **source** of **employment** opportunities, such as **chefs**, travel agents, tour guides and airline **cabin crew**. Tourists today can go on many different types of holidays such as adventure, sight-seeing and **cruises**. More and more visitors are attracted to Oman with its **stunning scenery** and **variety** of things to see and do. Demand is increasing for the **training** of **skilled** Omani workers in the hotels, restaurants and tourist centres. Tourist **professionals** with **formal qualifications** can work anywhere in the world.

The hospitality industry

💡 Oman is not famous only for its deserts: it has mountains, beaches, wadis, forests and deserts.

❁ ❁ ❁

Joe from Singapore

Joe liked **towns**. He walked around **Muttrah** and visited the souqs in **Salalah** and **Nizwa**.

Kate from New Zealand

Kate loved **wildlife**. She saw flamingos, whales and dolphins, and she watched **turtles** nesting at **Ras Al Hadd**.

Fernando from Brazil

Fernando loved **culture and heritage**, and the skilled craftsmen who make silver and pottery.

Scanning

Back at school, Salim's teacher gave the class a text about these six visitors.

> "Who loves history?" asked the teacher. "You have ten seconds!"

Salim didn't read everything. He **scanned**: he looked quickly for names, numbers and key words.

> "**Donna**!"

> "And where can you see turtles nesting?"

> "**Ras Al Hadd**!"

The hospitality industry

> "Tourism needs people," said the teacher. "The **hospitality industry** is one of the world's largest and fastest growing industries. It needs chefs, travel agents, tour guides and cabin crew. And demand is increasing for skilled Omani workers with formal **qualifications**."

Salim felt **proud**. Maybe one day he would be a tour guide, helping visitors to **explore** his country.

📖 Words from the story

hospitality industry قطاع الضيافة	**trek** يمشي مسافة طويلة صعبة
canyon وادٍ عميق ذو جوانب شديدة الانحدار	**awesome** رائع جدًا
explore يستكشف	**wildlife** الحياة البرية
proud فخور	**cruise** رحلة بحرية
destination وجهة	**qualifications** مؤهلات

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ In 2015 the New York Times listed Oman among the top destinations in the world
- ✔ Visitors enjoyed adventure (Jebel Shams), scenery (Dhofar), history (Nizwa, Bahla, Jibreen forts), souqs, wildlife (turtles at Ras Al Hadd) and heritage
- ✔ Wadi Ghul is the 'Grand Canyon of Oman'
- ✔ Scanning: look quickly for names, numbers or key words
- ✔ don't read everything
- ✔ The hospitality industry is one of the largest and fastest growing industries
- ✔ Demand is increasing for skilled Omani workers with formal qualifications

🤔 Little questions

1. Where can you see turtles nesting?
   Answer: Ras Al Hadd
2. Who loves history?
   Answer: Donna
3. Meaning of 'trek'?
   Answer: go on a long difficult walk
4. Meaning of 'canyon'?
   Answer: long deep valley with steep sides

The Careers Fair

A school story · Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

👥 Maryam and Shaima at a tourism careers fair

At the school careers fair, there were stands for many tourism jobs. Maryam and Shaima walked from stand to stand.

Who does what?

At each stand they wrote notes:

Travel agent: organises trips and holidays.

Chef: plans and creates menus.

Cabin crew: takes care of passenger safety.

Tour guide: shows people interesting places.

Hotel manager: makes sure a hotel runs smoothly and **oversees** the staff.



GRAMMAR RECALL

First Conditionals

An 'If' clause with the verb in the present tense, used with a main clause with the verb in the future tense, is called a first conditional clause. It expresses a possible condition and its probable result.

If you ***get*** *some training, you* ***will find*** *a job easily.*
If we ***don't hurry, we'll miss*** *our plane.*

Modal verbs are often used with first conditional 'If' clauses to express a variety of meanings. Read the sentences on the left and match them to a usage on the right.

1.	If you don't feel well, you **should** see a doctor.	**a.**	necessity
2.	If you want to be a chef, you **need to** enjoy cooking.	**b.**	advice, suggestion
3.	If we go to London, we **might** visit Buckingham Palace.	**c.**	permission
4.	If you finish your work early, you **may** go home.	**d.**	request
5.	If we visit Sri Lanka, we **can** see elephants.	**e.**	possibility (2 sentences)
6.	If you go food shopping, **could** you get me some bananas?		

Grammar Recall: first conditionals

If you..., you will...

At the hotel stand, the manager said:

> "**If you get** some training, **you will find** a job easily."

> "That's the **first conditional**," whispered Maryam. "**If + present simple, will + base verb.** It's for a possible **condition** and its probable **result**."

💡 First conditional: If + present simple, will + base verb. Never use 'will' in the if-clause.

At the airline stand, Shaima said:

> "If I will become cabin crew, I will travel the world!"

> "Careful," said Maryam. "Never use **will** in the **if** clause: *If I **become** cabin crew, I **will travel** the world.*"

❁ ❁ ❁

Modals in conditionals

The tour guide at the next stand gave advice using **modal verbs**:

> "If you want to be a tour guide, you **should** learn languages." (**should** = advice)

> "If you want to be a chef, you **need to** enjoy cooking." (**need to** = necessity)

> "If you work in a hotel, you **might** meet people from all over the world." (**might / can** = possibility)

> "If you finish the course, you **may** apply for our internship." (**may** = permission)

> "And if you go to the canteen, **could** you get me a coffee?" (**could** = request)

Everybody laughed.

Skills

> "What skills do you need?" Shaima asked the travel agent.

> "**Organisational skills**, to manage **reservations**. And you must be **patient**, especially with tired travellers."

The decision

On the way home Maryam said:

> "If I study hospitality, I'll become a hotel manager."

> "And if we don't hurry, we'll miss our bus!" said Shaima.

They ran.

📖 Words from the story

oversee يُشرف على	**cabin crew** طاقم الطائرة
reservation حجز	**organisational skills** مهارات تنظيمية
patient صبور	**condition** شرط
result نتيجة	**modal verb** فعل مساعد ناقص

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Tourism jobs: travel agent (organises trips), chef (creates menus), cabin crew (passenger safety), tour guide (shows places), hotel manager (runs the hotel)
- ✔ First conditional: If + present simple, will + base verb, for a possible condition and probable result
- ✔ Never use 'will' in the if-clause: If you visit Oman, you will love it
- ✔ Modals: should = advice, need to = necessity, might/can = possibility, may = permission, could = request

🤔 Little questions

1. Structure of the first conditional?
   Answer: If + present simple, will + verb
2. Which modal gives advice?
   Answer: should
3. What does a travel agent do?
   Answer: organises trips and holidays
4. Who takes care of passenger safety?
   Answer: cabin crew

Lesson 3-3 · Popular Destinations (Vocabulary: parts of speech)

The Top Five Quiz

A quiz story Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

👥 Salim and his classmates in a class quiz, and Mr Khalid

Mr Khalid started a quiz.

> "According to the World Tourism Organisation, 1,087 million tourists travelled abroad in 2014. Which country was number one?"

The top five

The class guessed, and Mr Khalid wrote the answers:

1 France (84.7 million): Paris, the Eiffel Tower, the French Alps.

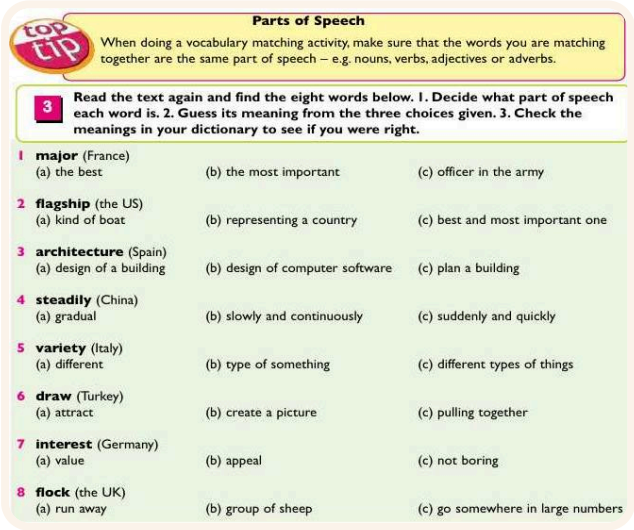
2 The US (69.8 million): Disney World, New York.

3 Spain (60.7 million): Madrid, Barcelona, and the **Alhambra Palace**, built by the **Muslims** in Granada.

4 China (55.7 million): the Great Wall, Shanghai.

5 Italy (47.7 million): Rome, Venice, Florence.

Then came Turkey, Germany and the UK.



Parts of Speech

top tip — When doing a vocabulary matching activity, make sure that the words you are matching together are the same part of speech – e.g. nouns, verbs, adjectives or adverbs.

3 Read the text again and find the eight words below. 1. Decide what part of speech each word is. 2. Guess its meaning from the three choices given. 3. Check the meanings in your dictionary to see if you were right.

1	**major** (France)		
	(a) the best	(b) the most important	(c) officer in the army
2	**flagship** (the US)		
	(a) kind of boat	(b) representing a country	(c) best and most important one
3	**architecture** (Spain)		
	(a) design of a building	(b) design of computer software	(c) plan a building
4	**steadily** (China)		
	(a) gradual	(b) slowly and continuously	(c) suddenly and quickly
5	**variety** (Italy)		
	(a) different	(b) type of something	(c) different types of things
6	**draw** (Turkey)		
	(a) attract	(b) create a picture	(c) pulling together
7	**interest** (Germany)		
	(a) value	(b) appeal	(c) not boring
8	**flock** (the UK)		
	(a) run away	(b) group of sheep	(c) go somewhere in large numbers

Matching words and meanings by part of speech

💡 In 2014 the most visited countries were France, the US, Spain, China and Italy.

Words from the text

"Now, round two: vocabulary," said Mr Khalid. "Match each word with its meaning. But here's the secret: **make sure they are the same part of speech**."

He wrote: **steadily**.

"What part of speech is it?"

"It ends in **-ly**," said Salim. "So it's an **adverb**."

"And the meaning?"

"**Slowly and continuously**: also an adverb!"

❁ ❁ ❁

More words

"**Draw**?"

"A **verb**: **attract**. Paris **draws** millions of tourists."

"**Architecture**?"

"A **noun** (it ends in **-ure**): the **design of a building**."

"**Flock**?"

"A verb: **go somewhere in large numbers**. *Tourists **flock** to London's museums every summer.*"

"**Major**?" — "**More important**."

"**Flagship**?" — "**The best and most important**, like a flagship hotel."

"**Variety**?" — "A noun: many different kinds."

Word endings

Mr Khalid wrote a final tip:

-ly = adverb.

-tion / -ure = noun.

-ful / -ous = adjective.

"If you match a verb with a noun meaning, you will make a mistake!"

The final question

"Who built the Alhambra?"

Salim raised his hand proudly. — "**The Muslims!**"

📖 Words from the story

major
أكثر أهمية / رئيسي

flagship
الأفضل والأهم

architecture
فن العمارة

steadily
بثبات وباستمرار

variety
تنوع

draw
يجذب

flock
يتوافد بأعداد كبيرة

destination
وجهة سياحية

noun / verb / adjective / adverb
اسم / فعل / صفة / ظرف

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ 1,087 million tourists travelled abroad in 2014
- ✔ The most visited countries: France (84.7 million), the US, Spain, China and Italy, then Turkey, Germany and the UK
- ✔ The Alhambra Palace in Granada was built by the Muslims
- ✔ When matching words with meanings, use the same part of speech: steadily (adverb) = slowly and continuously
- ✔ draw (verb) = attract
- ✔ architecture (noun) = design of a building
- ✔ flock (verb) = go somewhere in large numbers
- ✔ Endings: -ly adverb, -tion/-ure noun, -ful/-ous adjective

🤔 Little questions

1. Most visited country in 2014?
   Answer: France
2. Meaning of 'flock'?
   Answer: go somewhere in large numbers
3. Part of speech of 'architecture'?
   Answer: noun
4. Who built the Alhambra?
   Answer: the Muslims

Room 214

A hotel story Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

👥 Faisal, a student at the Oman Tourism College on his training at a hotel, and an unhappy guest

Faisal was studying for a **diploma** at the **Oman Tourism College**. This week he was training as a **receptionist** at a hotel. A receptionist welcomes guests and deals with their requests.

The angry guest

At 11 at night, a guest came to the desk. He was red in the face.

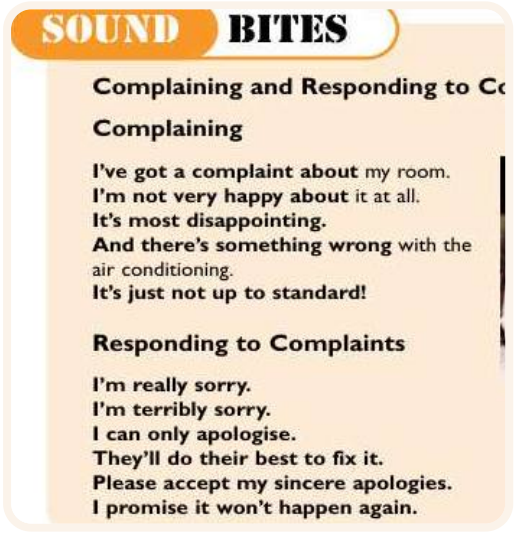
"Your hotel is terrible! Fix it now!"

Faisal stayed calm.

"Good evening, sir. How can I help?"

The guest took a deep breath.

"Sorry. Let me start again. **I've got a complaint about my room.** **There's something wrong with the air conditioning.** It's very hot. **I'm not very happy about it at all.**"



Soundbites: complaining and responding to complaints

💡 Complain politely: stay calm, describe the problem and say what you want.

Responding

Faisal remembered his lessons.

"**I'm terribly sorry**, sir. **I can only apologise.** Our engineers **will do their best to fix it** right away."

Ten minutes later, the engineer came back.

"It can't be fixed tonight."

Faisal moved the guest to a better room.

"**Please accept my sincere apologies. I promise it won't happen again.**"

❁ ❁ ❁

The next morning

The next morning, the guest came to the desk again.

"The new room is fine. But breakfast was **most disappointing**. The eggs were cold. **It's just not up to standard!**"

Up to standard means **good enough**.

"**I'm really sorry**, sir. I'll tell the restaurant manager now."

Then Faisal remembered a case from college: a group of tourists got **food poisoning** on a trip. The tour guide had to stay calm, get them to a doctor, and apologise to everyone.

The thank-you note

On the last day, the guest left a note:

"Dear Faisal, thank you for your patience and your smile. Service with a smile makes a good hotel."

Faisal's supervisor read it and smiled too.

"You **apologised**, you solved the problems, and you stayed polite. That's real hospitality."

📖 Words from the story

complaint شكوى	**apologise** يعتذر
disappointing مخيب للآمال	**up to standard** بالمستوى المطلوب
receptionist موظف الاستقبال	**diploma** دبلوم
food poisoning تسمم غذائي	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Complaining politely: I've got a complaint about... / I'm not very happy about it at all / It's most disappointing / There's something wrong with... / It's just not up to standard!
- ✔ Responding: I'm really sorry / I'm terribly sorry / I can only apologise / They'll do their best to fix it
- ✔ Please accept my sincere apologies / I promise it won't happen again
- ✔ Stay calm and polite: describe the problem and say what you want
- ✔ A receptionist welcomes guests and deals with their requests
- ✔ Up to standard means good enough

🤔 Little questions

1. Polite phrase to complain
   Answer: I've got a complaint about...
2. Polite phrase to apologise
   Answer: Please accept my sincere apologies
3. What does 'up to standard' mean?
   Answer: good enough
4. What does a receptionist do?
   Answer: welcomes guests and deals with their requests

Lesson 3-5 · Eating Out (Narrative essay)

The Mixed-Up Essay

A school story | Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

👥 Salim and Ahmed, and their teacher Mr Khalid

Mr Khalid gave the class six paragraphs on six cards. The title was **"A Nightmare Meal"**. But the cards were mixed up!

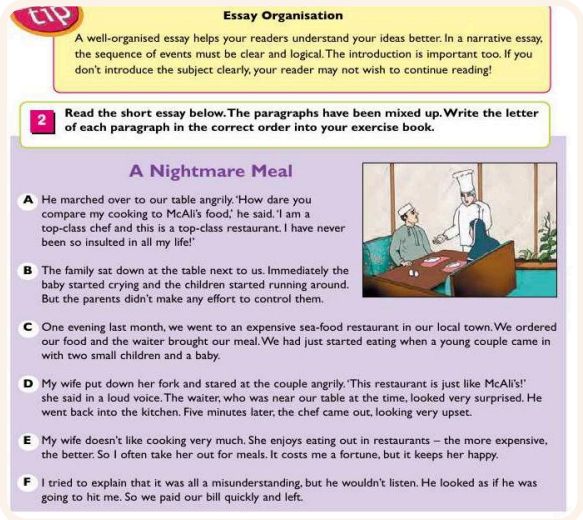
> "Put them in order," he said. "In a **narrative** essay, the **sequence** of events must be clear and logical."

Finding the beginning

Salim read all six cards.

> "Card **E** must be first. It's the **introduction**: *My wife enjoys eating out.* It makes the reader want to continue."

> "Then **C**," said Ahmed. "*One evening* we went to an expensive seafood restaurant. 'One evening' is a **time word**."



tip

Essay Organisation

A well-organised essay helps your readers understand your ideas better. In a narrative essay, the sequence of events must be clear and logical. The introduction is important too. If you don't introduce the subject clearly, your reader may not wish to continue reading!

2 **Read the short essay below. The paragraphs have been mixed up. Write the letter of each paragraph in the correct order into your exercise book.**

A Nightmare Meal

A He marched over to our table angrily. 'How dare you compare my cooking to McAli's food,' he said. 'I am a top-class chef and this is a top-class restaurant. I have never been so insulted in all my life!'

B The family sat down at the table next to us. Immediately the baby started crying and the children started running around. But the parents didn't make any effort to control them.

C One evening last month, we went to an expensive sea-food restaurant in our local town. We ordered our food and the waiter brought our meal. We had just started eating when a young couple came in with two small children and a baby.

D My wife put down her fork and stared at the couple angrily. 'This restaurant is just like McAli's!' she said in a loud voice. The waiter, who was near our table at the time, looked very surprised. He went back into the kitchen. Five minutes later, the chef came out, looking very upset.

E My wife doesn't like cooking very much. She enjoys eating out in restaurants – the more expensive, the better. So I often take her out for meals. It costs me a fortune, but it keeps her happy.

F I tried to explain that it was all a misunderstanding, but he wouldn't listen. He looked as if he was going to hit me. So we paid our bill quickly and left.

Essay organisation and 'A Nightmare Meal'

The events

> "Next is **B**: *A noisy family sat next to us.*"

> "Then **D**: *My wife compared the food to McAli's!*"

> "Then **A**: *The angry chef came over* — because he heard her!"

> "And finally **F**: *We paid quickly and left.*"

The order was: **E → C → B → D → A → F**.

> 💡 A narrative essay needs a good introduction, events in a clear sequence, and an ending. Use time words to show the order.

❁ ❁ ❁

Good and bad restaurants

"Now describe a restaurant," said Mr Khalid.

Ahmed described a bad one: **rude waiters**, a **long wait between courses**, **dirty cutlery**, **errors on the bill**, and **tables crowded together**.

Salim described a good one: **delicious food**, **attentive** service, a **varied menu**, attractive **décor**, **reasonable prices** and a **cosy atmosphere**.

"**Attentive** means paying close attention, helpful," said Salim. "*The waiters were attentive and the atmosphere was warm and friendly.*"

Writing their own

Then the boys wrote their own narrative essay about a **misunderstanding** in a restaurant. First they planned: **introduction → events in order → ending (result or feeling)**.

They used time words: *one evening, immediately, five minutes later, then*.

Ahmed's first draft jumped from event to event.

"Use **sequencing words**," said Salim. "Otherwise the reader gets lost."

Their essay began: *"One evening last month, my family went to a small restaurant in Sur..."* Mr Khalid smiled. A good introduction makes the reader want to continue.

📖 Words from the story

narrative قصصي / سردي	**sequence** تسلسل
atmosphere جو	**attentive** منتبه ومهتم
cutlery أدوات المائدة	**décor** ديكور
reasonable prices أسعار معقولة	**misunderstanding** سوء فهم

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ In a narrative essay the sequence of events must be clear and logical
- ✔ The introduction is important: it makes the reader want to continue
- ✔ Use time words: one evening, immediately, five minutes later, then
- ✔ 'A Nightmare Meal' order: E → C → B → D → A → F
- ✔ Good restaurant: delicious food, attentive service, varied menu, attractive décor, reasonable prices, cosy atmosphere
- ✔ Bad restaurant: rude waiters, long wait, dirty cutlery, errors on the bill, crowded tables

🤔 Little questions

1. Most important feature of a narrative essay?
   Answer: a clear and logical sequence of events
2. Two features of a bad restaurant
   Answer: rude waiters, dirty cutlery
3. Which paragraph comes first?
   Answer: E
4. Meaning of 'attentive'?
   Answer: paying close attention, helpful

The Chef Who Followed His Passion

A biography story · Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

👥 Maryam, who prepares a class presentation on Canada and on chef Issa Al Lamki

Maryam had to give a presentation with two parts: a country, and an Omani **role model**.

Part 1: Canada

Maryam showed a map.

"**Canada** is the second largest country in the world by area. It has ten **provinces** and three territories, and six time zones. It has the longest **coastline** in the world."

"What's the capital? Toronto?" asked a classmate.

"No! The capital is **Ottawa**. The population is 35 million, and the languages are English and French."

"How did Canada get its name?"

"From the word **'kanata'**, which means **'village'**."

"The highest point is **Mount Logan** (6,050 m). Winters are very cold, so there are many **glaciers**. The national sports are ice hockey and lacrosse. Visitors love the national parks, Niagara Falls and the CN Tower in Toronto."

Official name:	Canada
Location:	North America
Capital:	Ottawa
Population:	35 million
Area:	10 million km^2
Languages:	English, French
Currency:	Canadian dollar



Canada fact file

💡 In a fact file, use the headings (Capital, Population, Currency…) to answer questions quickly.

❁ ❁ ❁

Part 2: Issa Al Lamki

Then Maryam showed a photo of a smiling chef.

"This is **Issa Al Lamki**, an Omani **celebrity chef**."

> "When he was a boy, his mother noticed that he loved being in the kitchen, and his father supported him."

> "He trained at the **National Hospitality Institute (NHI)** in Muscat. In 1996 he was one of the first 13 chefs in Oman."

> "He worked in top hotels in Saudi Arabia, London and Berlin, with all their **luxury** and **amenities**."

> "In 2008 he returned to Oman to **promote Omani cooking**."

Fusion cooking

> "He created Omani **'fusion' cooking**: mixing Omani ingredients with classic recipes from other countries. He shows the world our **cuisine**."

> "What is his message?" asked the teacher.

> "He believes that **with passion for your work, nothing is impossible**."

The class clapped. After the presentation, Maryam went home and cooked dinner with her mother: Omani rice with a little Italian twist. A small fusion experiment!

📖 Words from the story

province مقاطعة	**coastline** ساحل
glacier نهر جليدي	**cuisine** مطبخ / أسلوب طهي
role model قدوة	**culinary** متعلق بالطهي
fusion cooking مطبخ مدمج	**amenities** وسائل الراحة
luxury فخامة	**voyage** رحلة بحرية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Canada: capital Ottawa, population 35 million, English and French, second largest country by area
- ✔ Ten provinces and three territories, six time zones, and the longest coastline in the world
- ✔ Its name comes from 'kanata' meaning 'village', and its highest point is Mount Logan (6,050 m)
- ✔ Issa Al Lamki trained at the NHI in Muscat and was one of the first 13 Omani chefs (1996)
- ✔ He worked in Saudi Arabia, London and Berlin, and returned in 2008 to promote Omani cooking
- ✔ He created Omani fusion cooking and believes that with passion nothing is impossible

🤔 Little questions

1. Capital of Canada?
   Answer: Ottawa
2. Highest mountain in Canada?
   Answer: Mount Logan
3. Where did Issa train?
   Answer: the National Hospitality Institute in Muscat
4. What is fusion cooking?
   Answer: mixing Omani ingredients with classic recipes from other countries



Lesson 4-1 · Aviation Then and Now (Reading: pronouns)

Flying on Coconut Oil

A science story Theme 4: Travel and Transport

👥 Salim and his father, a pilot with Oman Air

Salim's father was a pilot. One evening, Salim asked him:

"Dad, do planes cause pollution?"

"Yes. **Aviation** produces 2% of the world's carbon dioxide. By 2050 it will be 3%. Planes **emit** a lot of CO_2, so airlines want to reduce their **carbon footprint**."

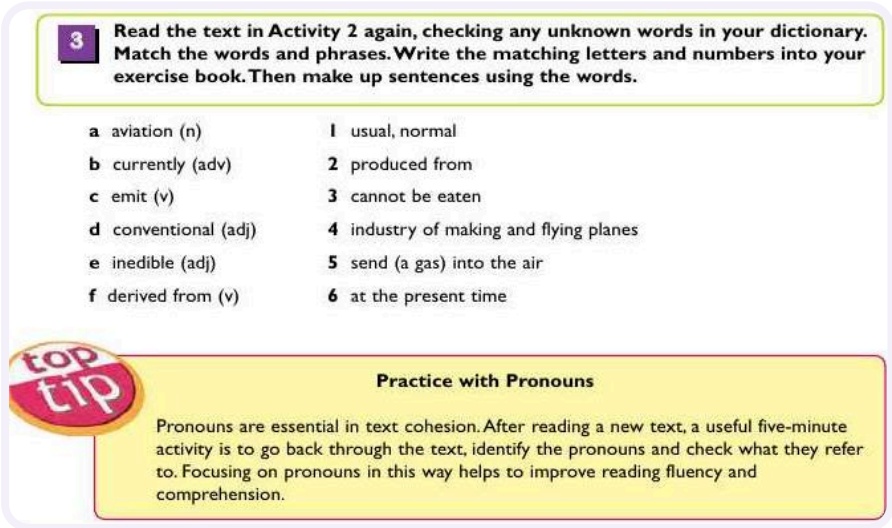
"How?"

"**One way they can do this** is with **biofuels**."

What does 'they' mean?

Salim's English homework was about this! The question said: *'One way they can do this...' – what does 'they' refer to?*

"**The airlines**," said Salim. "Pronouns are important for **cohesion**. After reading, I go back and find what each pronoun refers to. I look at the nouns in the sentence before."



3 **Read the text in Activity 2 again, checking any unknown words in your dictionary. Match the words and phrases. Write the matching letters and numbers into your exercise book. Then make up sentences using the words.**

a aviation (n)	**1** usual, normal
b currently (adv)	**2** produced from
c emit (v)	**3** cannot be eaten
d conventional (adj)	**4** industry of making and flying planes
e inedible (adj)	**5** send (a gas) into the air
f derived from (v)	**6** at the present time

top tip

Practice with Pronouns

Pronouns are essential in text cohesion. After reading a new text, a useful five-minute activity is to go back through the text, identify the pronouns and check what they refer to. Focusing on pronouns in this way helps to improve reading fluency and comprehension.

Vocabulary matching and pronouns tip

💡 To find what a pronoun refers to, look back at the nouns in the previous sentence.

The first biofuel flight

"A **biofuel** is fuel produced from living matter like plants and trees," said Father. "Not from petroleum."

"Who used it first?"

"In February 2008, **Virgin Atlantic** flew a Boeing 747 from London to Amsterdam using 20% biofuel, made from coconut and babassu oil. **It** carried pilots and technicians."

"**It** = the Virgin Atlantic plane!" said Salim.

❁ ❁ ❁

More biofuels

"In 2011 biofuels were approved for flights. KLM carried 171 passengers from Amsterdam to Paris."

"What are biofuels made from?"

"Used cooking oil, **inedible** corn oil, sugar-based biofuel, and even **algae**."

"**Inedible** means it cannot be eaten?"

"Exactly. We don't want to use food that people need. **Conventional** fuel is the normal fuel we **currently** use. Biofuel is **derived from** plants."

The best title

Salim skimmed the article for his homework and chose the best title: **"The Use of Biofuels in Aviation."**

"What do you think?" asked Father. "Are biofuels a good idea?"

"Yes, if they are made from things we can't eat. It's an **ambitious** plan, but the sky should stay clean."

"And less **congestion** at airports would be nice too!" laughed Father.

📖 Words from the story

aviation الطيران	**biofuel** وقود حيوي
emit يُطلق (غازًا)	**conventional** تقليدي / عادي
currently حاليًا	**derived from** مُشتق من
inedible غير صالح للأكل	**carbon footprint** البصمة الكربونية
congestion ازدحام	**ambitious** طموح

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Aviation produces 2% of the world's CO_2, and by 2050 it will be 3%
- ✔ Airlines are testing biofuels made from plants, algae and used cooking oil, not from petroleum
- ✔ In February 2008 Virgin Atlantic flew a Boeing 747 from London to Amsterdam using 20% biofuel (coconut and babassu oil)
- ✔ In 2011 biofuels were approved, and KLM carried 171 passengers from Amsterdam to Paris
- ✔ Pronouns are essential for cohesion: look back at the nouns to find what they refer to
- ✔ Best title: The Use of Biofuels in Aviation

🤔 Little questions

1. What is a biofuel?
   Answer: fuel produced from living matter like plants
2. Which airline first used biofuel?
   Answer: Virgin Atlantic
3. Meaning of 'inedible'?
   Answer: cannot be eaten
4. Meaning of 'emit'?
   Answer: send (a gas) into the air

Lesson 4-2 · Congestion – A Growing Issue (Present perfect & continuous)

Miss Smith's Letter

A letter story Theme 4: Travel and Transport

👥 Miss Smith, a teacher who is late every day, and the City Council

The letter

Dear City Council,

*I **have been living** in this city for six months. I **have been driving** to work every day, and I **have been** late every single day because of **traffic congestion**.*

*This morning I **have spent** one hour in a **traffic jam**. I am **exhausted**, **irritated**, **frustrated** and **stressed**.*

*I **have written** to you twice before, but nothing **has changed**. Please start a **campaign** to reduce traffic.*

Yours faithfully,

Miss Smith

GRAMMAR RECALL

Present Perfect and Present Perfect Continuous

Read the sentences and match them to the usage on the right.

1 **I've been living** in Muscat for six months.
2 A terrible hurricane **has just happened** in America.
3 **Have you ever been** to Thailand? No, but **I've visited** Malaysia.
4 Our exams **have been getting** more and more difficult.
5 The number of students graduating from Sultan Qaboos University **has increased** each year.

*Use the **present perfect** for expressing –*

a an action or experience in the past when the experience is more important than stating the time
b an action which started in the past but which is not finished
c an action which happened recently and which affects the present; often used for news items

*Use the **present perfect continuous** for expressing:*

d an action or experience which started in the past and is still continuing
e an action which started in the past, and has been continuing and now affects the present

Grammar Recall: present perfect and present perfect continuous

In class

Salim's class read the letter.

> "Why is Miss Smith unhappy?" asked Mr Khalid.

> "Because she is late for work every day because of the traffic."

> "Good. Now look at the grammar. She uses two tenses."

Present perfect

"The **present perfect** is **have/has + past participle**. We use it for:

an **experience** when the time is not important: *Have you ever **been** to Thailand?*

an action that started in the past and is **not finished**;

and a **recent action that affects the present**, like news: *A terrible hurricane **has just happened**.*"

Present perfect continuous

"The **present perfect continuous** is **have/has been + verb-ing**. We use it for an action that started in the past and is **still continuing**: *I**'ve been living** in Muscat for six months.* Or a recent continuing action that affects the present: *Your eyes are red. **Have** you **been crying**?*"

> 💡 Use the continuous form to focus on the activity and how long; use the simple form for the result or completed action.

❁ ❁ ❁

The fishing trip

Mr Khalid told a story:

"Last Friday, I went fishing. After three hours, my son asked, 'What **have** you **been doing** all morning?' I said, 'I**'ve been fishing** all morning.' Then suddenly I shouted, 'I**'ve caught** a fish!'"

The class laughed.

"**Been fishing**: the activity, how long. **Caught**: the result."

Quick practice

"*I'm so tired. I've (studied / been studying) all evening.*"

"**Been studying**!" said Salim. "The activity."

"*Here's a newsflash! Two prisoners have (escaped / been escaping).*"

"**Escaped**! It's news, a completed action."

"And one last mistake: *I am living in Muscat since 2020.*"

"*I **have been living** in Muscat since 2020!*"

📖 Words from the story

congestion ازدحام مروري	**traffic jam** اختناق مروري
council مجلس بلدي	**exhausted** منهك
irritated منزعج	**frustrated** محبط
stressed متوتر	**campaign** حملة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Miss Smith writes to the City Council because she is late every day due to traffic congestion
- ✔ Present perfect = have/has + past participle: experiences, unfinished actions, and recent news
- ✔ Present perfect continuous = have/has been + -ing: actions that started in the past and are still continuing
- ✔ Use the continuous for the activity and how long, and the simple for the result
- ✔ I've been fishing all morning (activity) vs I've caught a fish (result)
- ✔ With 'since' and 'for' use the present perfect (continuous), not the present continuous

🤔 Little questions

1. Form of the present perfect continuous?
   Answer: have/has been + -ing
2. Why is Miss Smith unhappy?
   Answer: she is late for work every day because of traffic
3. Complete: I've ___ (catch) a fish!
   Answer: caught
4. Complete: I've been ___ (fish) all morning.
   Answer: fishing

The Simulator

A road-safety story | Theme 4: Travel and Transport

👥 Salim, who is learning to drive, and an officer at the Traffic Safety Institute in Muscat

Salim was eighteen and learning to drive. His school took the class to the **Traffic Safety Institute** in Muscat. A police officer met them.

The words of the road

"Before you drive, you must know the words," said the officer.

"A **speed bump** is a raised area across a road. You find them in **residential areas**, the districts where people live."

"A **fatality** is a death in an accident. Our **statistics**, sets of numbers, show that speed causes many fatalities."

"Always wear your **seatbelt**. And remember the **minimum** age for driving: the minimum is the smallest amount."

1. **speed bump**	(a) exciting ride at the funfair (b) raised area across a road (c) something that hits you very fast	
2. **residential areas**	(a) districts where people live (b) districts where people work (c) districts where people go shopping	
3. **fatality**	(a) something that is final (b) the opposite of success (c) death in an accident	
4. **statistics**	(a) mathematical problems (b) sets of numbers representing measurements (c) sets of things that do not change position	
5. **minimum**	(a) the smallest amount (b) the largest amount (c) the average amount	
6. **simulator**	(a) camera used to control speeding (b) police supervisor (c) machine used in training people	



Courtesy of Royal Oman Police

top tip

Multiple Choice Questions

When dealing with multiple choice questions, read through all the possible choices before choosing one. If you eliminate the answers which are incorrect, you will be left with the correct answer. This applies equally to reading and listening multiple choice questions.

Watch out for qualifying words like 'always,' 'sometimes,' or 'never' which can change the meaning of statements.

Road-safety vocabulary and multiple choice tip

The simulator

Then he showed them a **simulator**, a machine used in training people. Salim sat in it. On the screen, a car suddenly stopped in front of him. Salim hit the brakes, his heart racing.

"Good reaction," said the officer. "Now, imagine you are angry. What happens?"

Road rage

> "**Road rage** is aggressive behaviour by angry drivers. They shout, they flash their lights, they drive too close."

Then the class listened to drivers talking about what made them angry: slow drivers in the fast lane, people using their phones, cars cutting in.

> "If you feel angry," said the officer, "**stay calm, take a deep breath, and leave early to avoid stress**."

> 💡 Road rage is aggressive behaviour by angry drivers. Stay calm, breathe deeply and leave early.

❁ ❁ ❁

The quiz

At the end, there was a multiple choice quiz.

Question: Speed bumps are found mostly in...

a) motorways b) residential areas c) always in the desert d) car parks

Salim almost chose (a). Then he remembered the teacher's tip:

Read all the possible choices before deciding.

Eliminate the answers you know are incorrect. He crossed out (c) and (a).

Watch out for qualifying words like **always**, **sometimes**, **never**: they can change the meaning. Option (c) said 'always' — wrong!

He chose **(b) residential areas**. Correct!

On the way home, Salim's father drove behind a slow truck. Salim smiled.

> "Stay calm, Dad. Take a deep breath."

📖 Words from the story

speed bump
مطب

residential areas
مناطق سكنية

fatality
حالة وفاة في حادث

statistics
إحصائيات

minimum
الحد الأدنى

simulator
جهاز محاكاة للتدريب

road rage
غضب الطريق

seatbelt
حزام الأمان

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Speed bump: raised area across a road
- ✔ residential areas: districts where people live
- ✔ Fatality: death in an accident
- ✔ statistics: sets of numbers representing measurements
- ✔ Minimum: the smallest amount
- ✔ simulator: machine used in training people
- ✔ Road rage is aggressive behaviour by angry drivers: stay calm, breathe and leave early
- ✔ Multiple choice: read all choices, eliminate wrong answers, watch for words like always, sometimes, never

🤔 Little questions

1. Meaning of 'speed bump'?
   Answer: raised area across a road
2. Meaning of 'simulator'?
   Answer: machine used in training people
3. What is road rage?
   Answer: aggressive behaviour by angry drivers
4. Strategy for MCQs?
   Answer: read all choices and eliminate wrong ones



Lesson 4-4 · Jobs in Airports and Aviation (Asking for explanations)

A Day in the Tower

An interview story Theme 4: Travel and Transport

👥 Maryam and her classmates on a visit to Muscat International Airport, and Tariq, an air traffic controller

Maryam's class visited **Muscat International Airport**. First, they walked through the terminal and saw many people at work.

Who does what?

Their guide explained:

Airport manager: has overall responsibility for running the airport.

Check-in agent: helps passengers check in and answers questions.

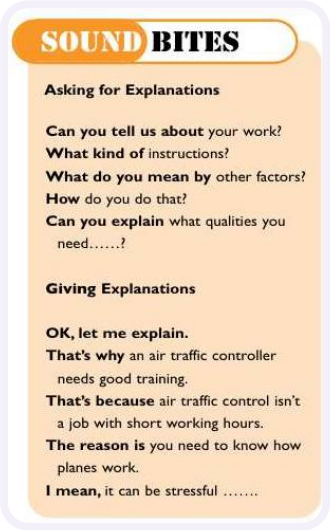
Baggage handler: weighs and transports luggage.

Security personnel: monitor cameras and maintain order.

Emergency services: firefighters, medical staff and police.

Mechanic: carries out repairs and makes sure machines are safe.

And the most exciting one: the **air traffic controller**, who gives instructions and directions to pilots.



Soundbites: asking for and giving explanations

In the tower

They climbed the control tower and met **Tariq**, an air traffic controller.

> "**Can you tell us about** your work?" asked Maryam.

"**OK, let me explain.** I watch all the planes near the airport and tell the pilots when to land and take off, and which **runway** to use."

"**What do you mean by** 'runway'?"

"**I mean** the long road where planes land and take off."

> 💡 Ask for explanations with 'Can you tell us about...?' or 'What do you mean by...?'; give them with 'That's because...' or 'The reason is...'.

❁ ❁ ❁

Why so much training?

"**Can you explain** why you need so much training?" asked Shaima.

"**That's because** we are responsible for the safety of many planes at the same time. One mistake can be dangerous."

"**How do you do that?** It looks so difficult."

"**The reason is** practice. We train for years on simulators before we work in the real tower."

A common mistake

Later, a classmate asked: "Can you explain me the rules?"

Tariq smiled. — "We say: *Can you explain the rules **to me**?*"

The last question

"How do you find your job?" asked Maryam.

Tariq looked at a plane landing softly on the runway.

"**Rewarding**. Every day, thousands of people arrive home safely. **That's why** I love it."

📖 Words from the story

air traffic controller
مراقب الحركة الجوية

check-in agent
موظف تسجيل الركاب

baggage handler
عامل الأمتعة

security personnel
موظفو الأمن

runway
مدرج الطائرات

emergency services
خدمات الطوارئ

rewarding
مُجزٍ

mechanic
ميكانيكي

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Airport jobs: manager (runs the airport), air traffic controller (gives instructions to pilots), check-in agent (helps passengers), baggage handler (weighs and transports luggage)
- ✔ Security personnel monitor cameras
- ✔ emergency services are firefighters, medical staff and police
- ✔ mechanics carry out repairs
- ✔ Asking: Can you tell us about...? / What do you mean by...? / How do you do that? / Can you explain...?
- ✔ Giving: OK, let me explain / That's why... / That's because... / The reason is... / I mean...
- ✔ Say 'Can you explain the rules to me?', not 'explain me'
- ✔ Tariq finds his job rewarding

🤔 Little questions

1. Who gives instructions to pilots?
   Answer: air traffic controller
2. Who weighs and transports luggage?
   Answer: baggage handler
3. Phrase to give an explanation
   Answer: That's because...
4. How does Tariq find his job?
   Answer: rewarding

The Railway Essay

A school story | Theme 4: Travel and Transport

👥 Ahmed, who writes an essay about the Oman Rail Project, and Mr Khalid

Ahmed's homework was to write an **informative essay**. He chose the **Oman Rail Project**.

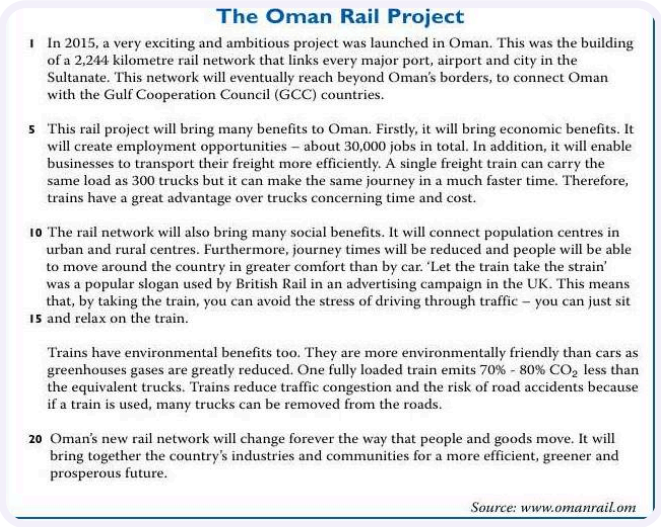
Planning

Mr Khalid showed him the structure:

Introduction: present the topic.

Body paragraphs: each with a **topic sentence** and **supporting sentences**.

Conclusion: summarise the main points.



The Oman Rail Project

In 2015, a very exciting and ambitious project was launched in Oman. This was the building of a 2,244 kilometre rail network that links every major port, airport and city in the Sultanate. This network will eventually reach beyond Oman's borders, to connect Oman with the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) countries.

This rail project will bring many benefits to Oman. Firstly, it will bring economic benefits. It will create employment opportunities – about 30,000 jobs in total. In addition, it will enable businesses to transport their freight more efficiently. A single freight train can carry the same load as 300 trucks but it can make the same journey in a much faster time. Therefore, trains have a great advantage over trucks concerning time and cost.

The rail network will also bring many social benefits. It will connect population centres in urban and rural centres. Furthermore, journey times will be reduced and people will be able to move around the country in greater comfort than by car. 'Let the train take the strain' was a popular slogan used by British Rail in an advertising campaign in the UK. This means that, by taking the train, you can avoid the stress of driving through traffic – you can just sit and relax on the train.

Trains have environmental benefits too. They are more environmentally friendly than cars as greenhouses gases are greatly reduced. One fully loaded train emits 70% - 80% CO_2 less than the equivalent trucks. Trains reduce traffic congestion and the risk of road accidents because if a train is used, many trucks can be removed from the roads.

Oman's new rail network will change forever the way that people and goods move. It will bring together the country's industries and communities for a more efficient, greener and prosperous future.

Source: www.omanrail.om

The Oman Rail Project essay

The introduction

*The Oman Rail Project was launched in 2015. It is a 2,244 km **network** that will link ports, airports and major cities, and later the GCC countries.*

Body paragraph 1: Economic benefits

*Firstly, the railway has economic **benefits**. It will create about 30,000 jobs. **Moreover**, one **freight** train can carry the same load as 300 trucks.*

Body paragraph 2: Social benefits

*In addition, there are social benefits. The railway connects urban and rural areas. **As a result**, travel will be more comfortable.*

Body paragraph 3: Environmental benefits

Furthermore, trains produce 70–80% less CO_2 than trucks. There will be less congestion and fewer accidents.

The conclusion

*Eventually, Oman will be more connected and **prosperous**. **Therefore**, the rail project is good for everyone.*

> 💡 An informative essay: introduction, body paragraphs (topic sentence + supporting sentences), conclusion.

❁ ❁ ❁

The conjunctions

Mr Khalid read the essay and said:

> "Excellent! Your **conjunctions** make it **coherent** and smooth. Let's name their types."

Types of Conjunctions	Examples
1 addition	**a** in the same way, similarly
2 contrast	**b** because, due to
3 reason	**c** moreover, also, in addition, furthermore
4 time	**d** for example, such as
5 result	**e** but, although, however
6 example	**f** therefore, as a result
7 similarity	**g** before, then, firstly, eventually

Types of conjunctions

Addition: moreover, also, in addition, furthermore.

Contrast: but, although, however.

Reason: because, due to.

Result: therefore, as a result.

Example: for example, such as.

Time: before, then, firstly, eventually.

Similarity: in the same way, similarly.

One small mistake

Ahmed had written one more sentence: "However I like trains, I drive."

> "That's a contrast, but '**however**' doesn't work here. Use '**although**': *Although I like trains, I drive.*"

"Like this?" said Ahmed. "*Although parents cannot change other drivers, they can make their own car safer.*"

"Perfect."

📖 Words from the story

informative إخباري / معلوماتي	**network** شبكة
freight البضائع المنقولة	**benefit** فائدة
employment opportunities فرص عمل	**prosperous** مزدهر
conjunction أداة ربط	**coherent** مترابط

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The Oman Rail Project (launched 2015) is a 2,244 km network linking ports, airports and cities, and later the GCC
- ✔ Economic benefits: about 30,000 jobs, and one freight train carries the same load as 300 trucks
- ✔ Social benefits: connects urban and rural areas
- ✔ environmental: 70–80% less CO_2, less congestion and fewer accidents
- ✔ Informative essay: introduction, body paragraphs with topic and supporting sentences, conclusion
- ✔ Conjunctions: addition (moreover), contrast (although, however), reason (because), result (therefore), example, time, similarity

🤔 Little questions

1. Length of the Oman rail network?
   Answer: 2,244 km
2. One freight train equals how many trucks?
   Answer: 300
3. Type of 'moreover'?
   Answer: addition
4. Type of 'because'?
   Answer: reason

The Floating Train

A travel story Theme 4: Travel and Transport

👥 Salim and his father on two trips: to Spain and to Shanghai

Trip 1: Spain

Last year, Salim visited **Spain** with his family. In Granada, they visited the **Alhambra**.

"Who built this beautiful palace?" asked Salim.

"**Muslims of Arab and Berber origin**," said his father. "Muslims ruled much of Spain for centuries."

Salim wrote in his notebook:

Capital: Madrid. **Population**: 47.27 million. **Currency**: Euro.

Spain and Portugal make up the Iberian **peninsula**. Spain is a **monarchy**.

Over 50 million tourists visit Spain every year.

The writer **Miguel de Cervantes** wrote *Don Quixote*.

Trip 2: Shanghai

This year, Salim's father had a business trip to Shanghai, and Salim went with him. At the airport, they took a special train: the **Shanghai Maglev**.

"**Maglev** means **magnetic levitation**," said his father. "The train doesn't run on wheels. It **floats** 10–15 mm above the track, on a **guideway**, using electromagnets."



The Shanghai Maglev Train

💡 The Shanghai Maglev floats above its guideway using electromagnets and reaches 431 km/h.

❁ ❁ ❁

The fastest ride

A screen in the train showed the speed: 200… 300… 400… **431 km/h**!

> "It started on 1 January 2004," said Father. "It was the first high-speed long-distance maglev in the world. It goes 30 km to Longyang Road in **under 8 minutes**. By taxi it takes about an hour!"

Why is it better?

> "Why don't the guideways wear out?" asked Salim.

> "**Because there is no contact between the train and the guideway, so there is no friction.** That's why maintenance is cheaper."

> "Other advantages: it is **non-polluting**, it uses less energy, and it is very safe. But it cost 1.2 billion dollars."

A comparison table

Salim made a table to compare transport: speed, cost, journey time and environment. In the last row he wrote:

*The maglev is a **pioneer**: fast, clean and quiet.*

Back home, he showed his photos to the class. One classmate said: "The maglev runs on wheels, right?"

> "No! It floats above the guideway using electromagnets!"

📖 Words from the story

peninsula
شبه جزيرة

monarchy
نظام ملكي

maglev (magnetic levitation)
الرفع المغناطيسي

guideway
مسار التوجيه

friction
احتكاك

non-polluting
غير ملوث

pioneer
رائد

benefit
فائدة

railway track
سكة حديد

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Spain: capital Madrid, population 47.27 million, currency Euro
- ✔ with Portugal it makes up the Iberian peninsula
- ✔ Muslims of Arab and Berber origin built palaces like the Alhambra in Granada
- ✔ Over 50 million tourists visit Spain every year, and Cervantes wrote Don Quixote
- ✔ Maglev = magnetic levitation: it floats 10–15 mm above the track using electromagnets
- ✔ The Shanghai Maglev (1 January 2004) reaches 431 km/h and goes 30 km in under 8 minutes
- ✔ No contact means no friction: cheaper maintenance, non-polluting, less energy, very safe
- ✔ it cost 1.2 billion dollars

🤔 Little questions

1. Capital of Spain?
   Answer: Madrid
2. What does maglev stand for?
   Answer: magnetic levitation
3. Top speed of the Shanghai Maglev?
   Answer: 431 km/h
4. Where is the Alhambra?
   Answer: Granada